

THE · STORY · OF · BLUE · BEARD :
FROM · PERRAULT · ILLUSTRATED · WITH · PICTURES · AND ·
ORNAMENTS · BY · JOSEPH · E. ·
SOUTHALL : MDCCCXCV



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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE STORY OF
BLUE-BEARD ***



THE STORY OF BLUE BEARD



The : Story : of : Blue-Beard
from Perrault illustrated
with pictures and orna-
-ments by Joseph
E. Southall.



London-Lawrence
: and Bullen :
Chicago Stone
& Kimball
1895
V

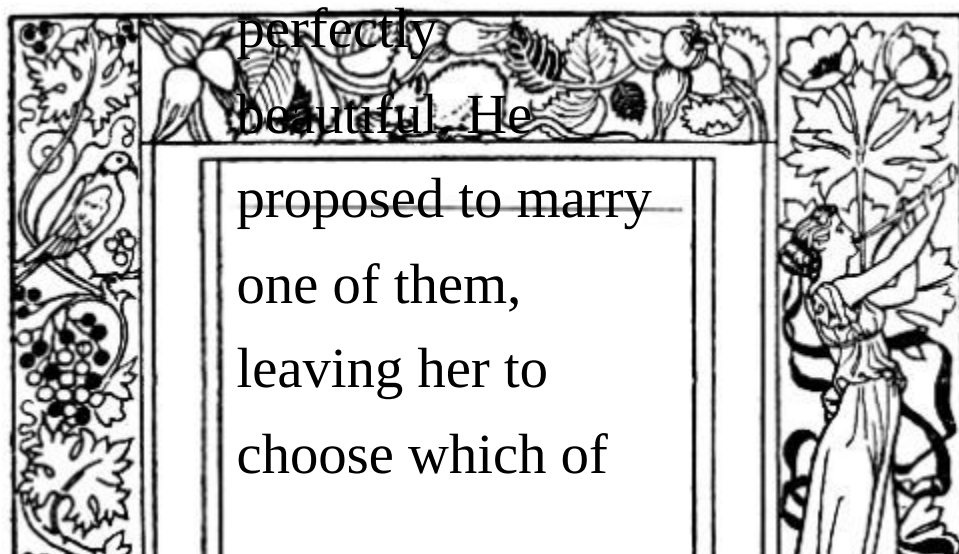
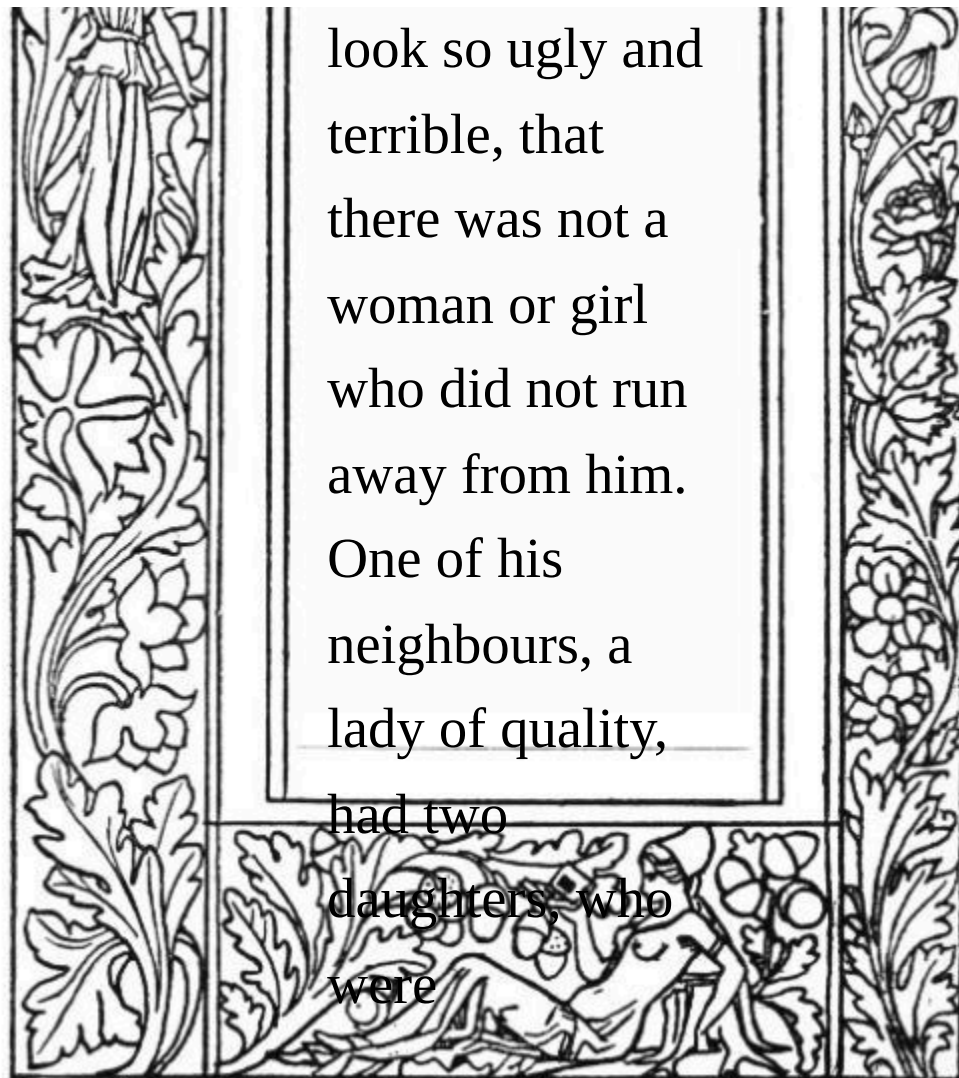
BLUE BEARD

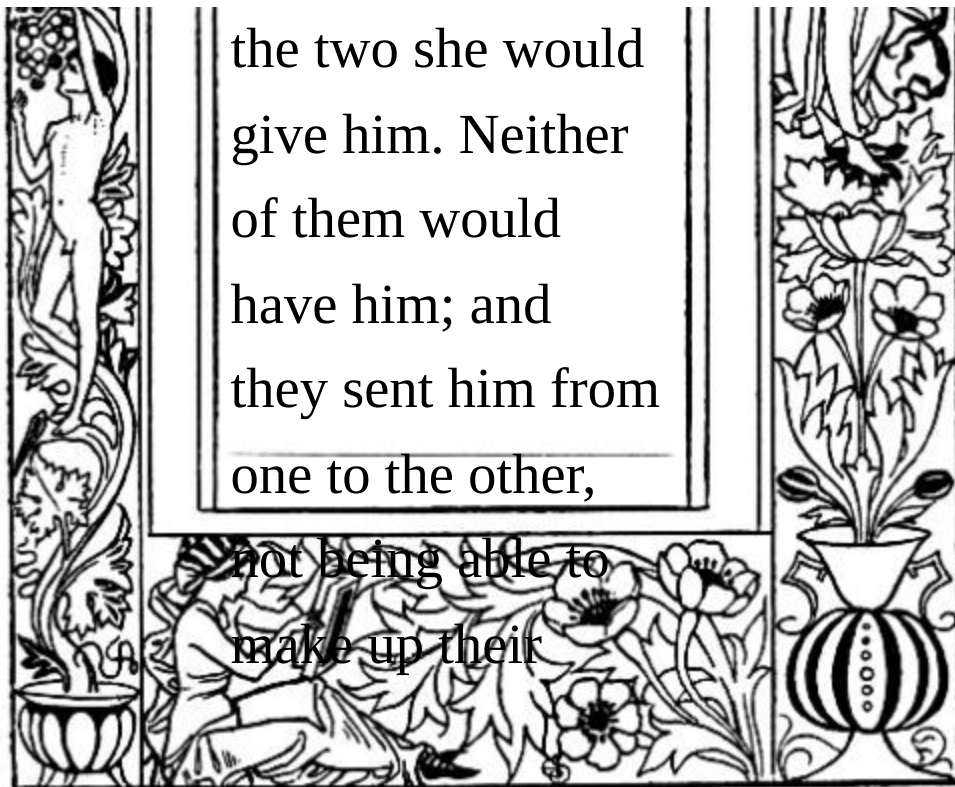
Once on a time
there was a man
who had fine town
and country
houses, gold and
silver plate,
embroidered
furniture, and
coaches gilt all
over; but

unfortunately,

this man had a
blue beard,

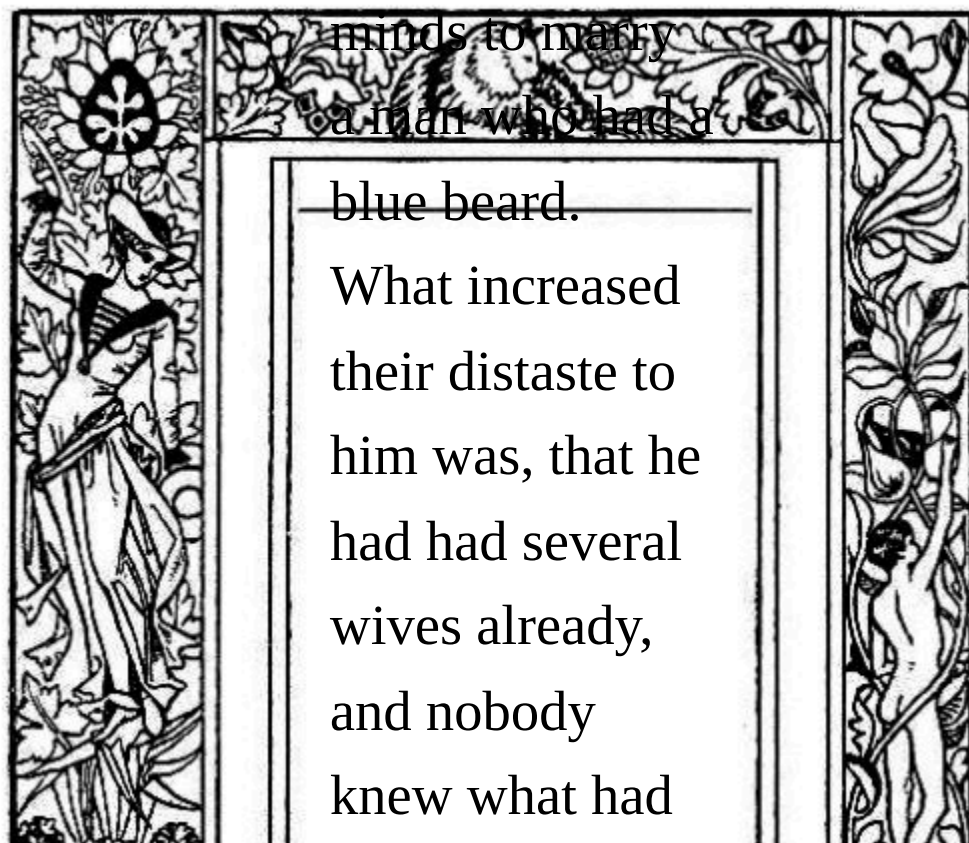
which made him





the two she would
give him. Neither
of them would
have him; and
they sent him from
one to the other,

not being able to
make up their

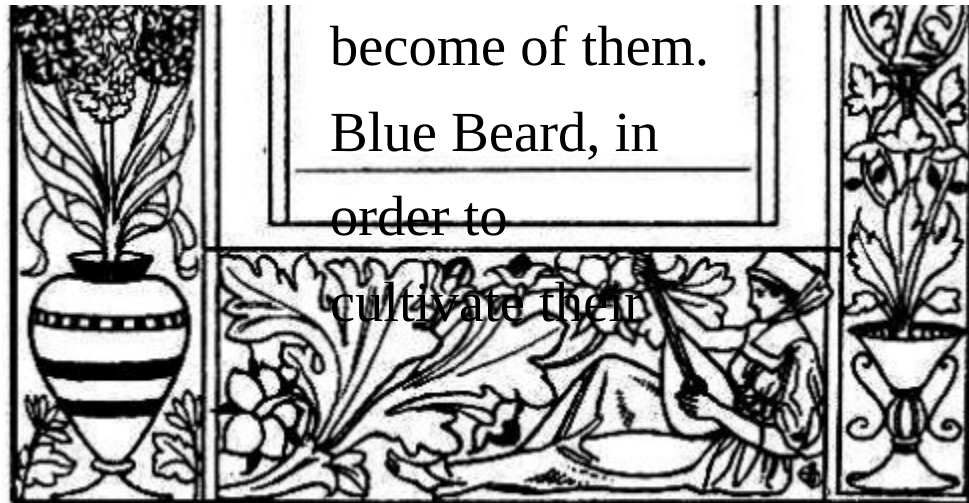


minds to marry

a man who had a

blue beard.

What increased
their distaste to
him was, that he
had had several
wives already,
and nobody
knew what had

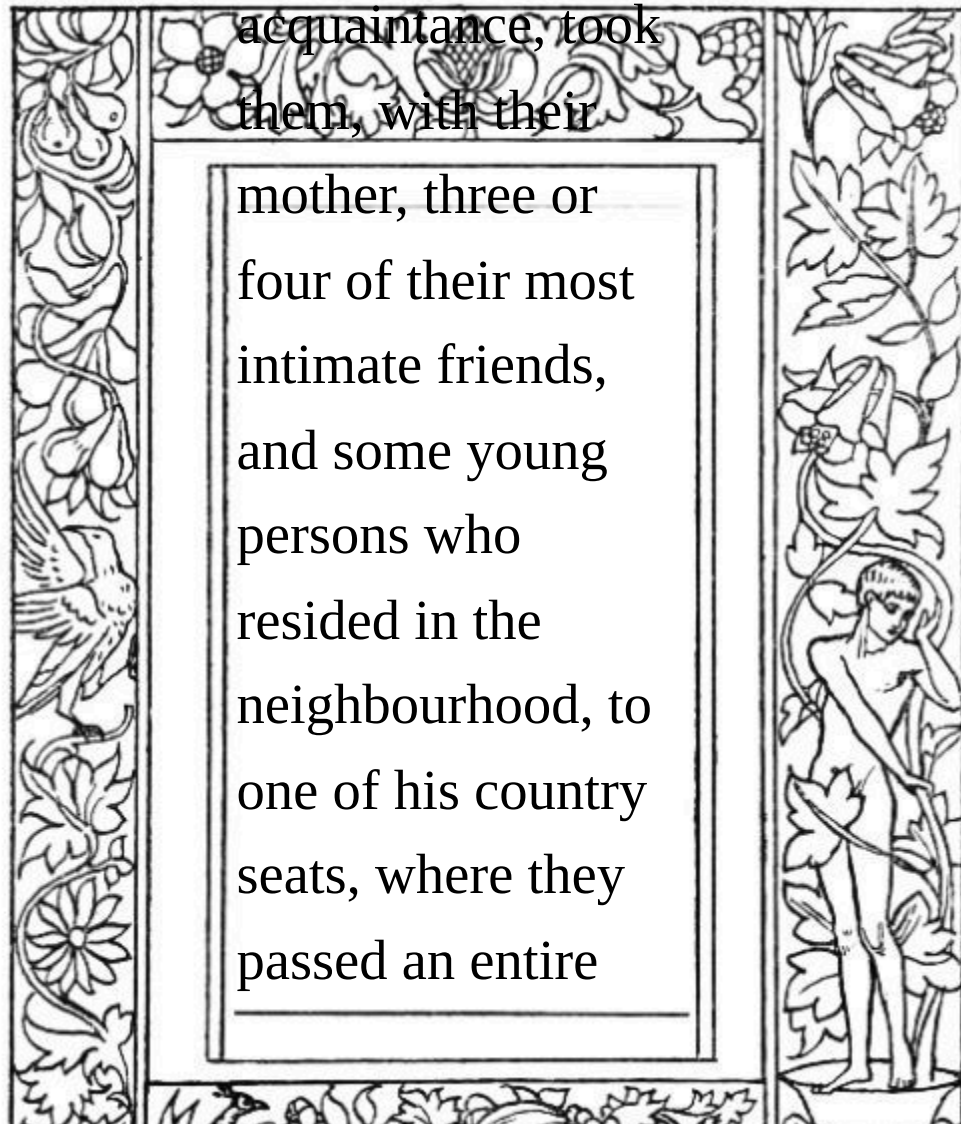


become of them.

Blue Beard, in

order to

cultivate their



acquaintance, took

them, with their

mother, three or

four of their most

intimate friends,

and some young

persons who

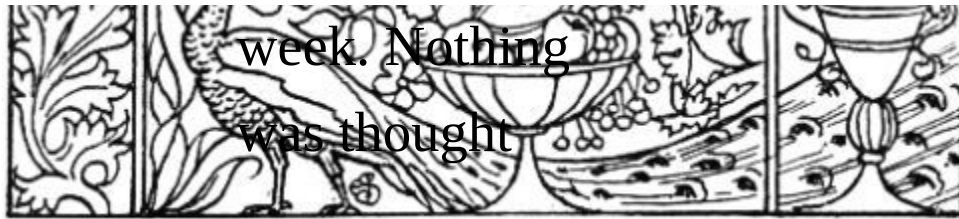
resided in the

neighbourhood, to

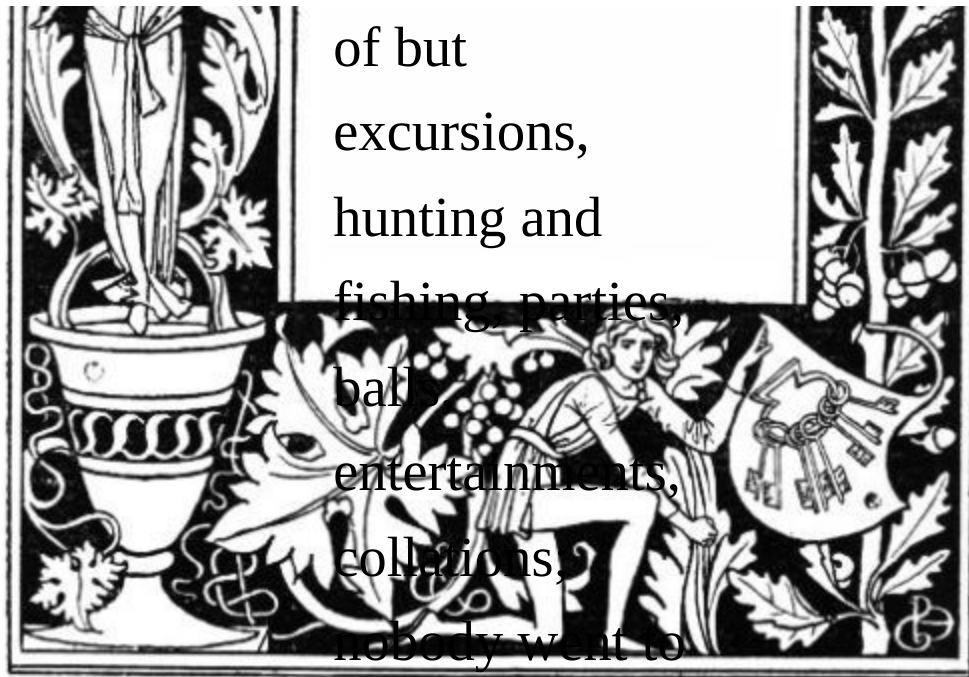
one of his country

seats, where they

passed an entire



week. Nothing
was thought



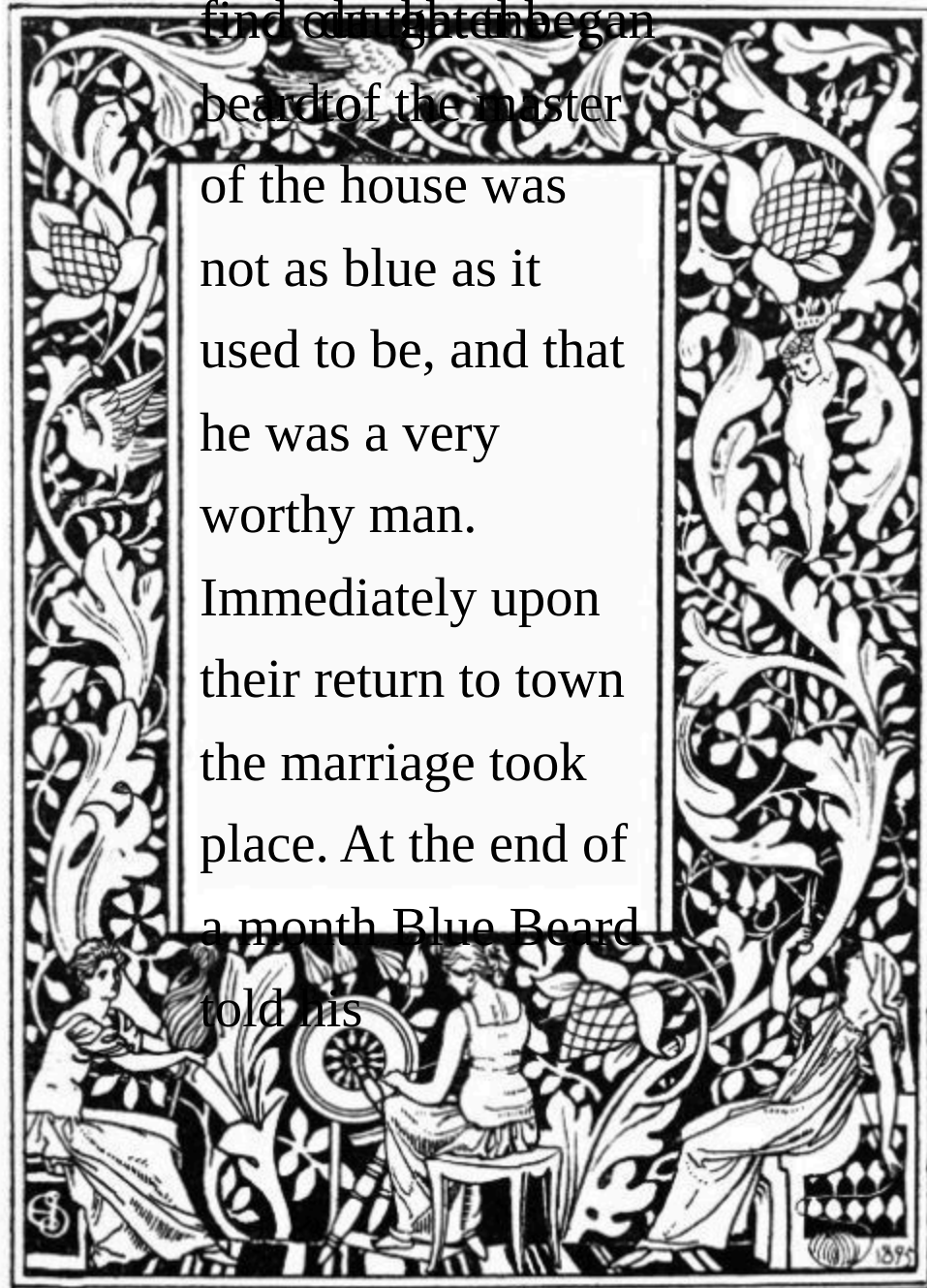
of but
excursions,
hunting and
fishing parties,
ball
entertainments,
collations,
nobody went to

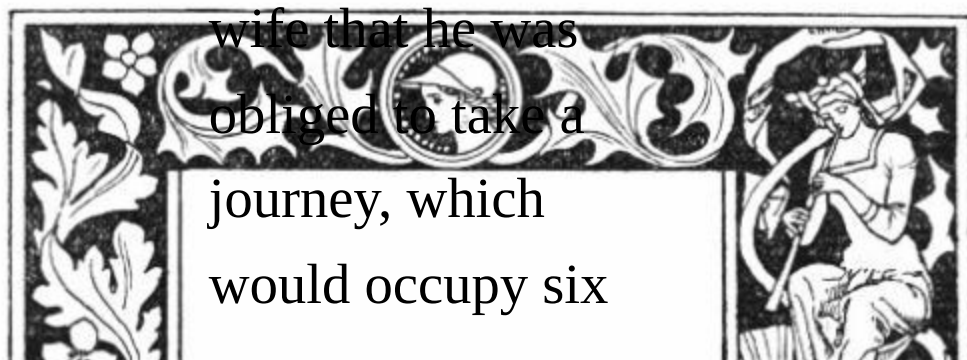
bed; the whole
night was spent
in merry games
and gambols. In
short, all went
off so well, that
the youngest

find out that he began
beard of the master

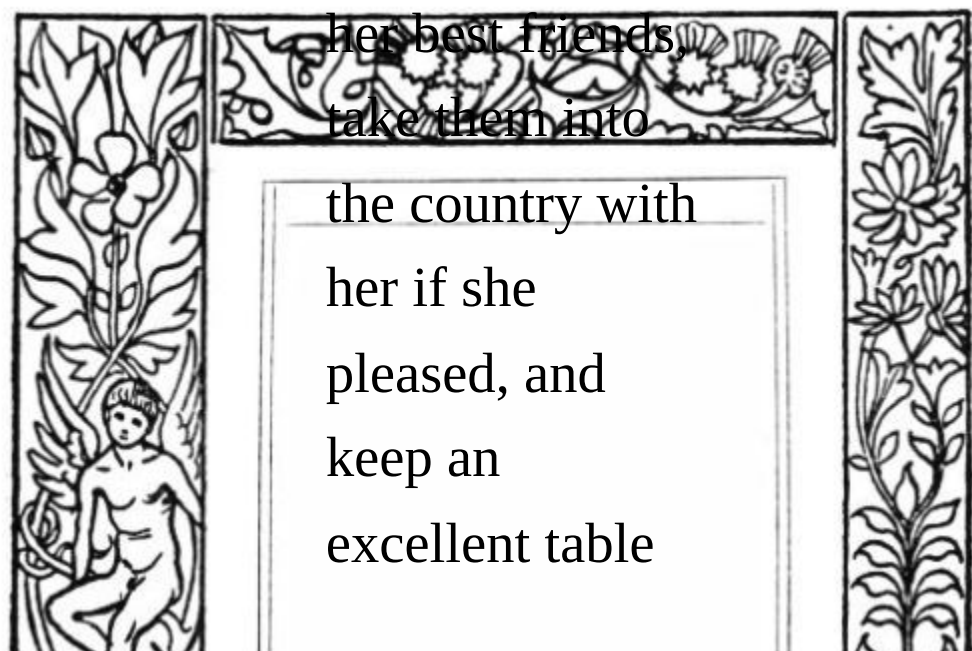
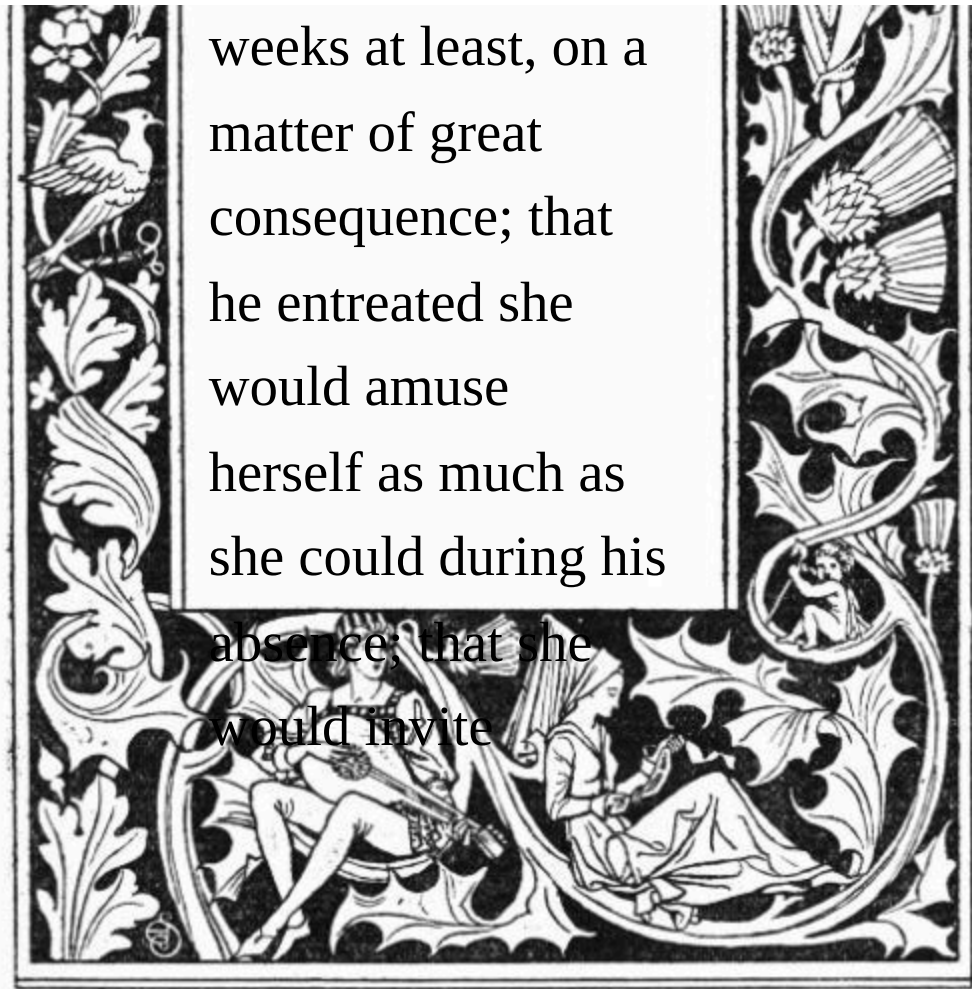
of the house was
not as blue as it
used to be, and that
he was a very
worthy man.

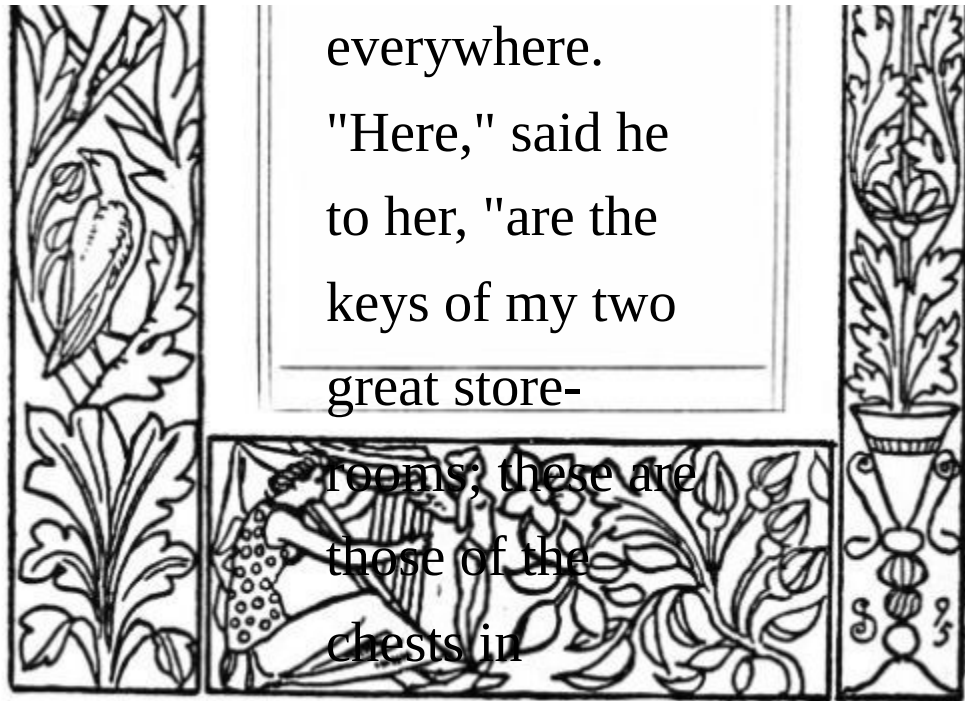
Immediately upon
their return to town
the marriage took
place. At the end of
a month Blue Beard
told his





wife that he was
obliged to take a
journey, which
would occupy six

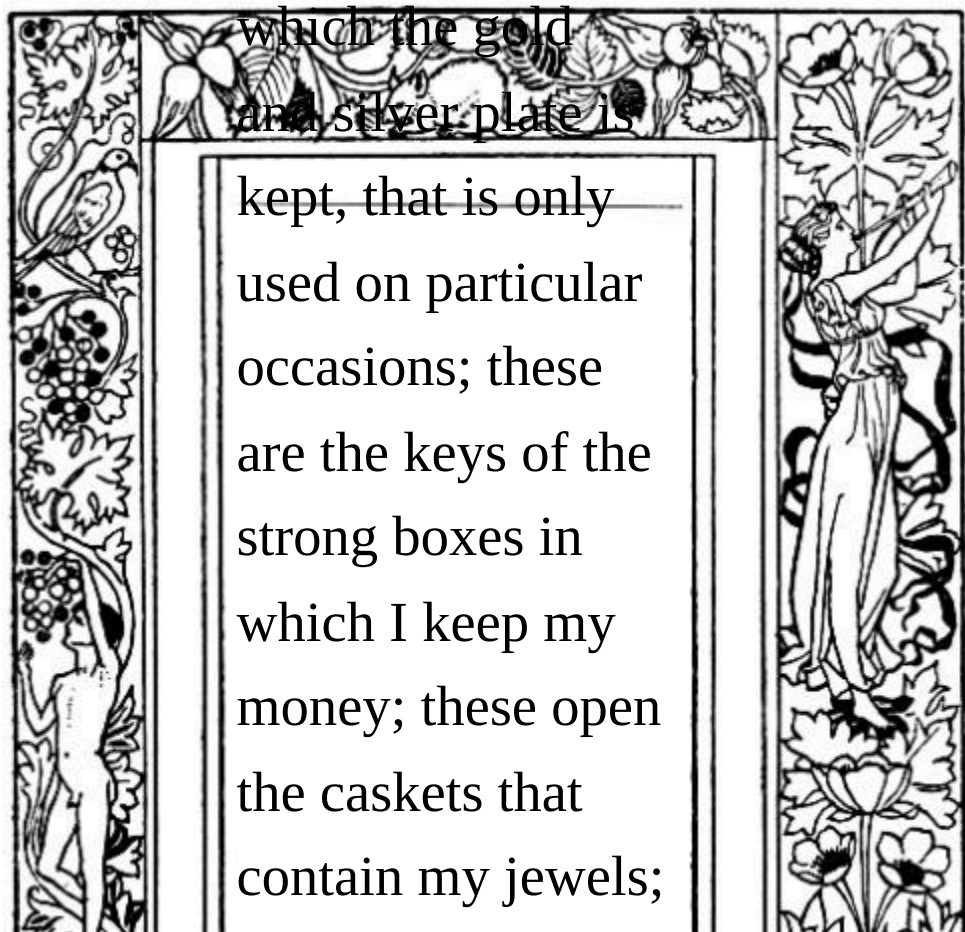




everywhere.

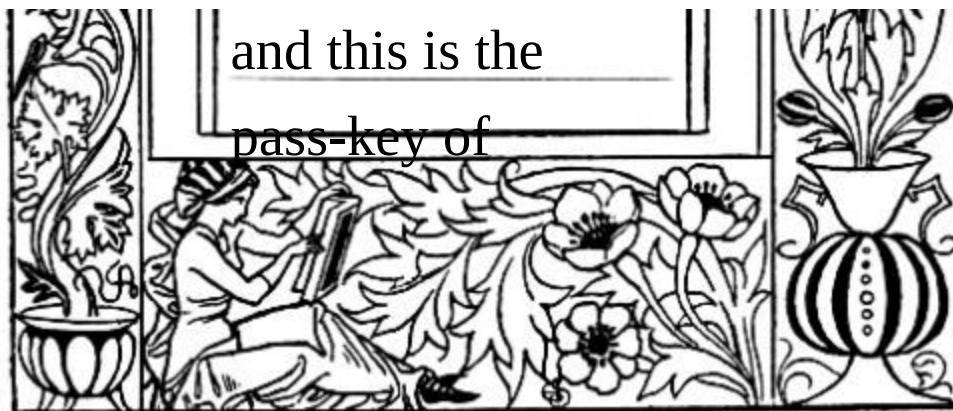
"Here," said he
to her, "are the
keys of my two
great store-

rooms; these are
those of the
chests in

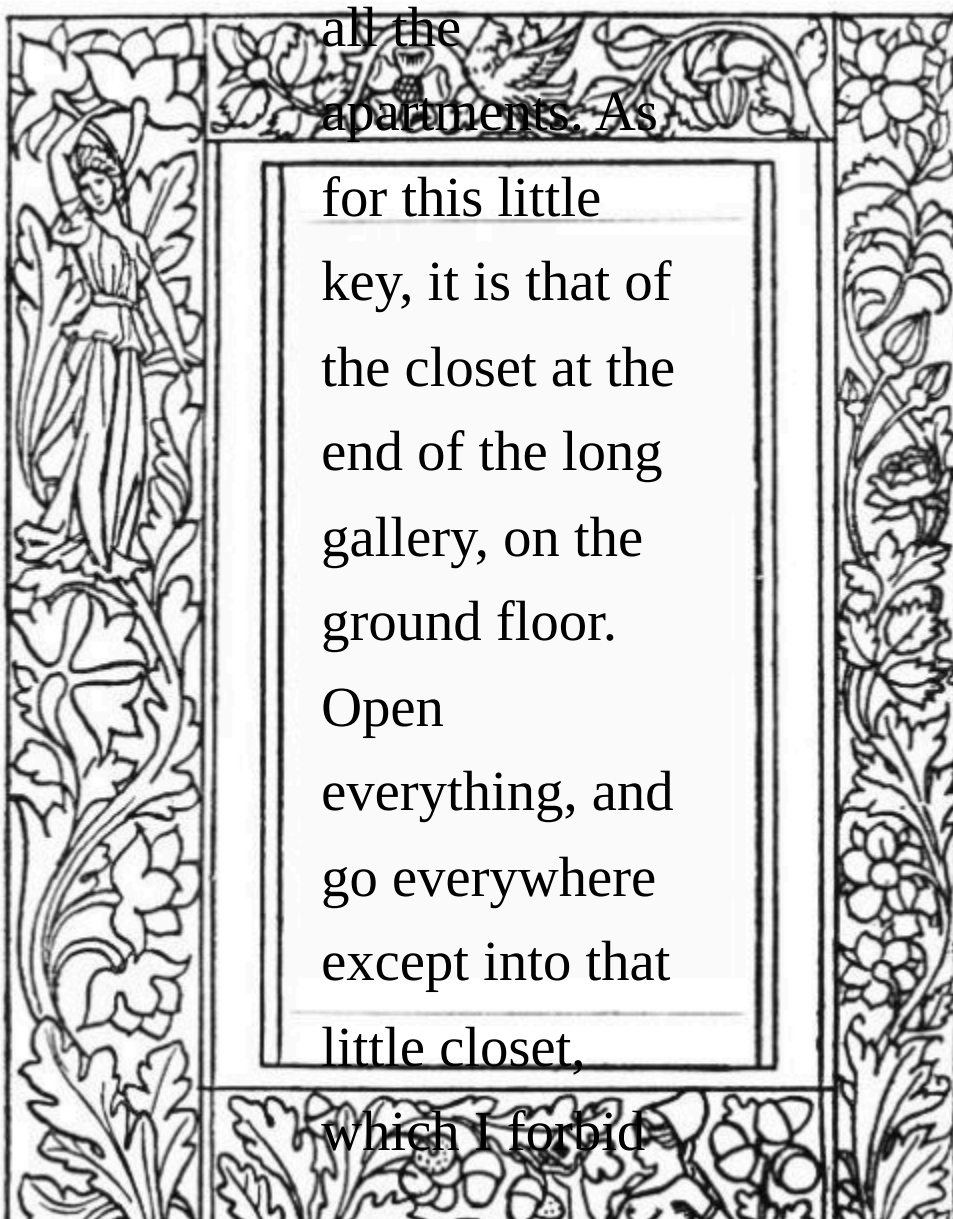


which the gold
and silver plate is

kept, that is only
used on particular
occasions; these
are the keys of the
strong boxes in
which I keep my
money; these open
the caskets that
contain my jewels;



and this is the
pass-key of



all the
apartments. As

for this little
key, it is that of
the closet at the
end of the long
gallery, on the
ground floor.

Open
everything, and
go everywhere
except into that
little closet,

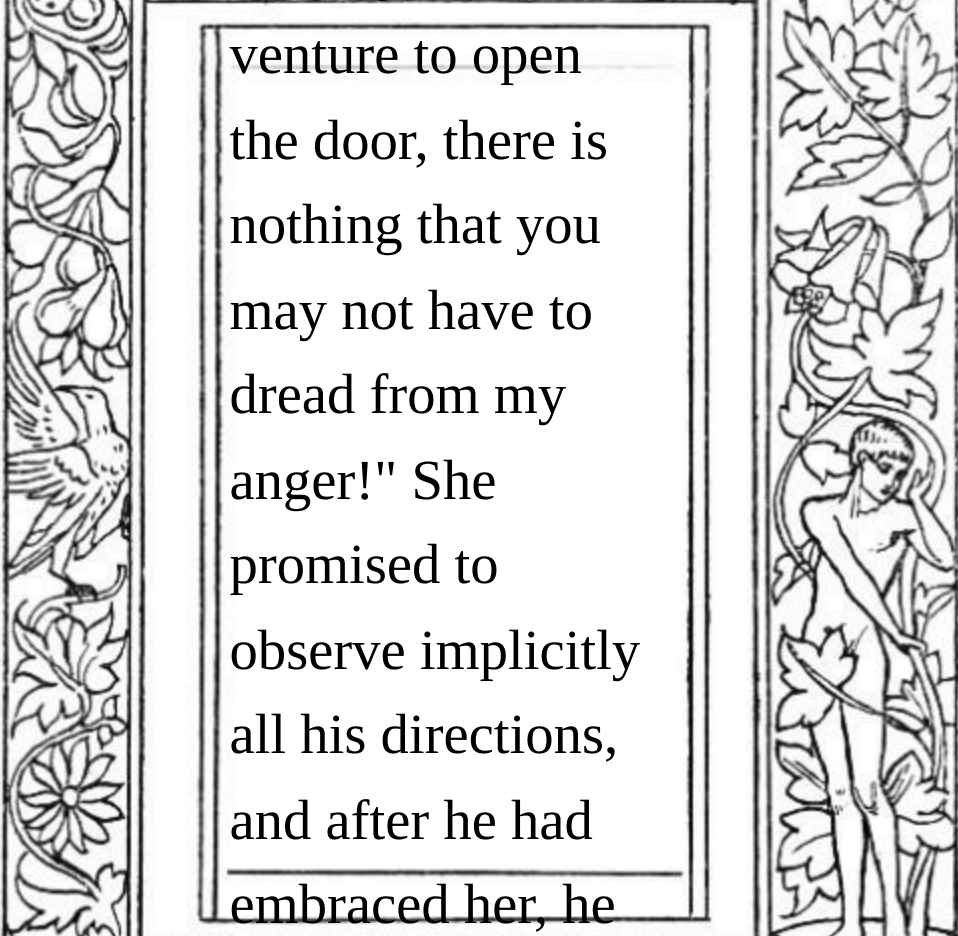
which I forbid



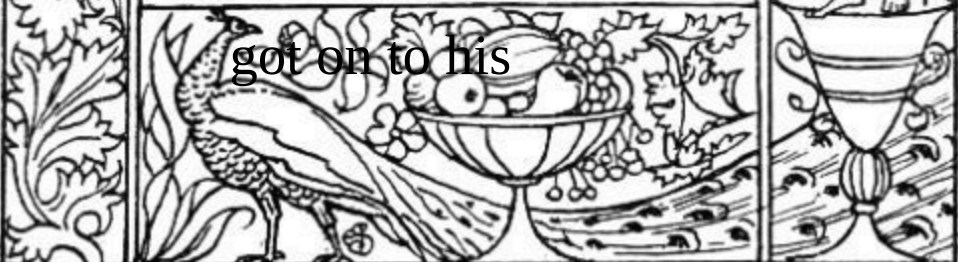
you to enter, and
I forbid



you so strictly,
that if you should



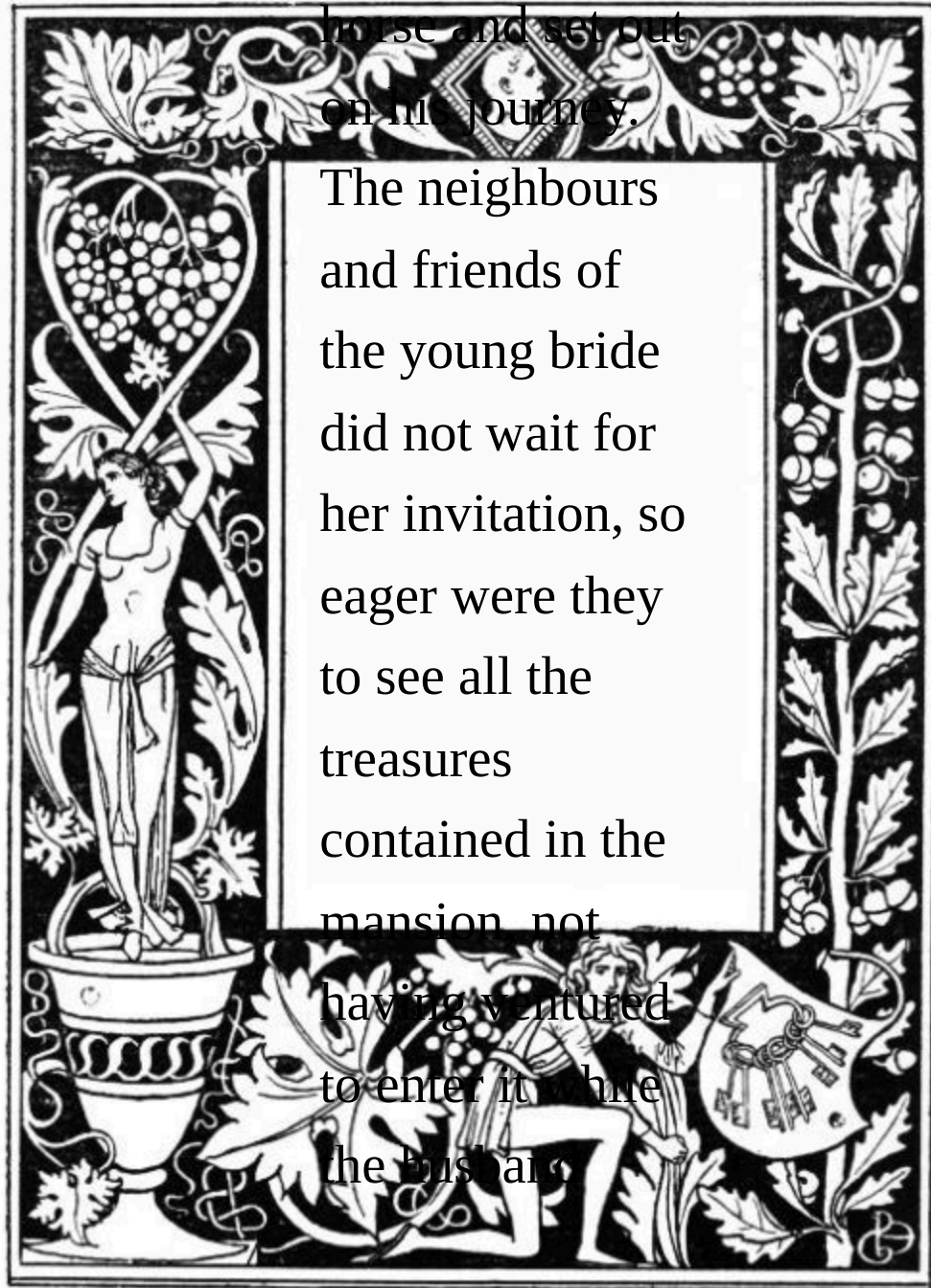
venture to open
the door, there is
nothing that you
may not have to
dread from my
anger!" She
promised to
observe implicitly
all his directions,
and after he had
embraced her, he



got on to his

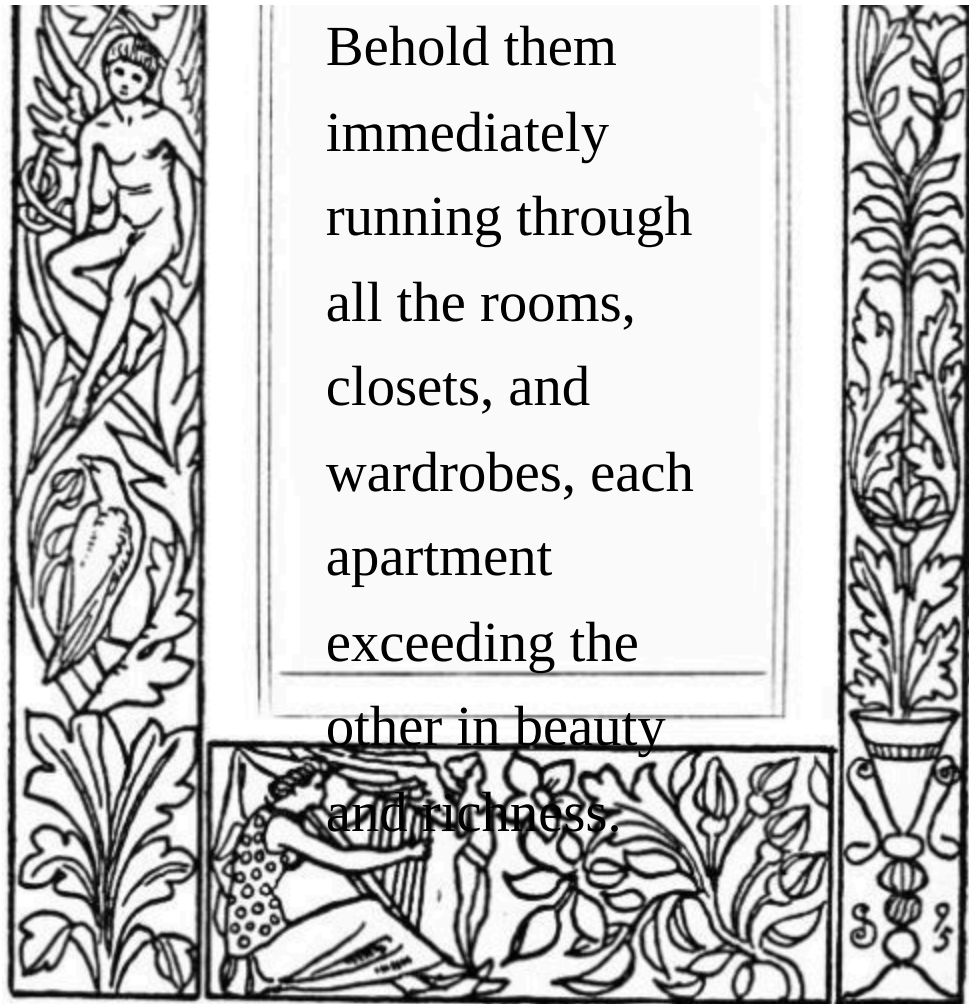
haste and set out
on his journey.

The neighbours
and friends of
the young bride
did not wait for
her invitation, so
eager were they
to see all the
treasures
contained in the
mansion, not
having ventured
to enter it, while
the bishop

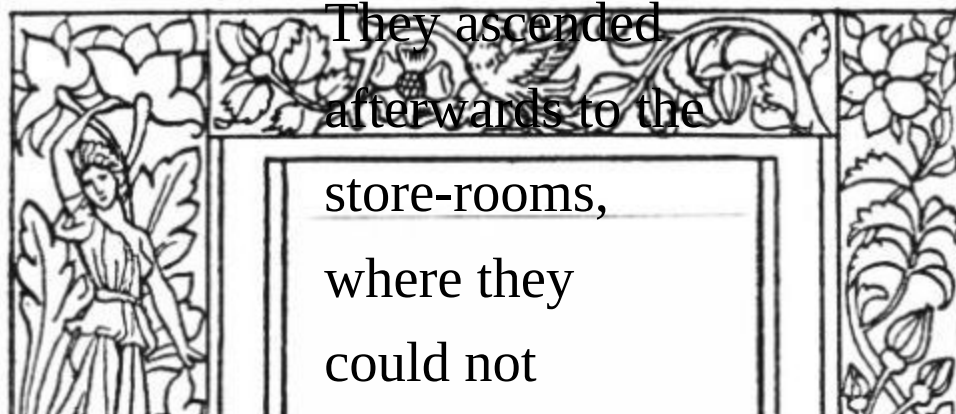


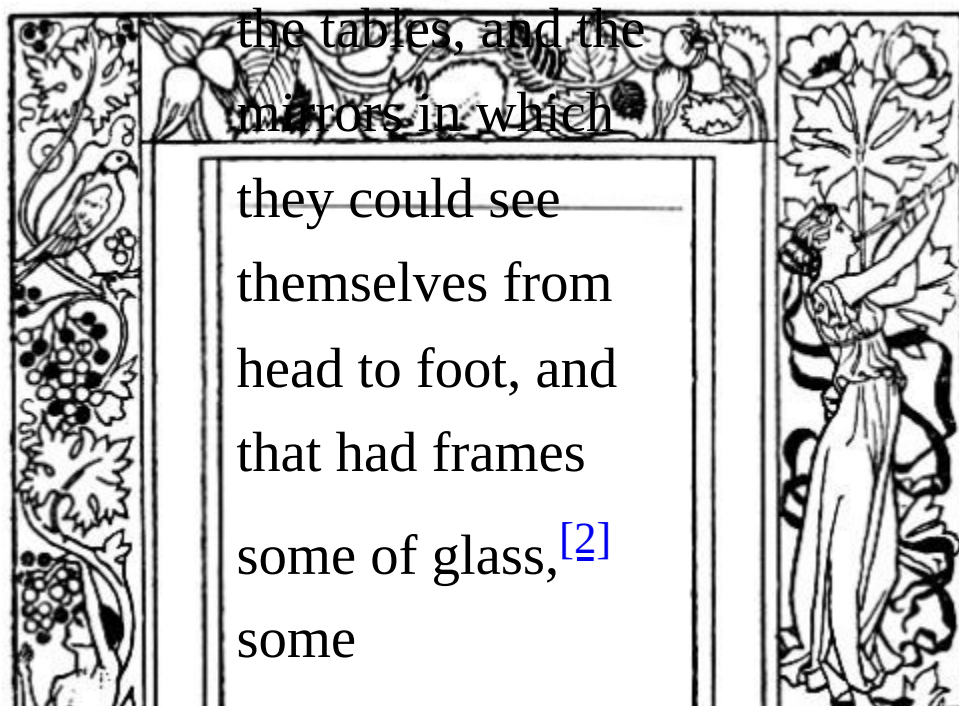
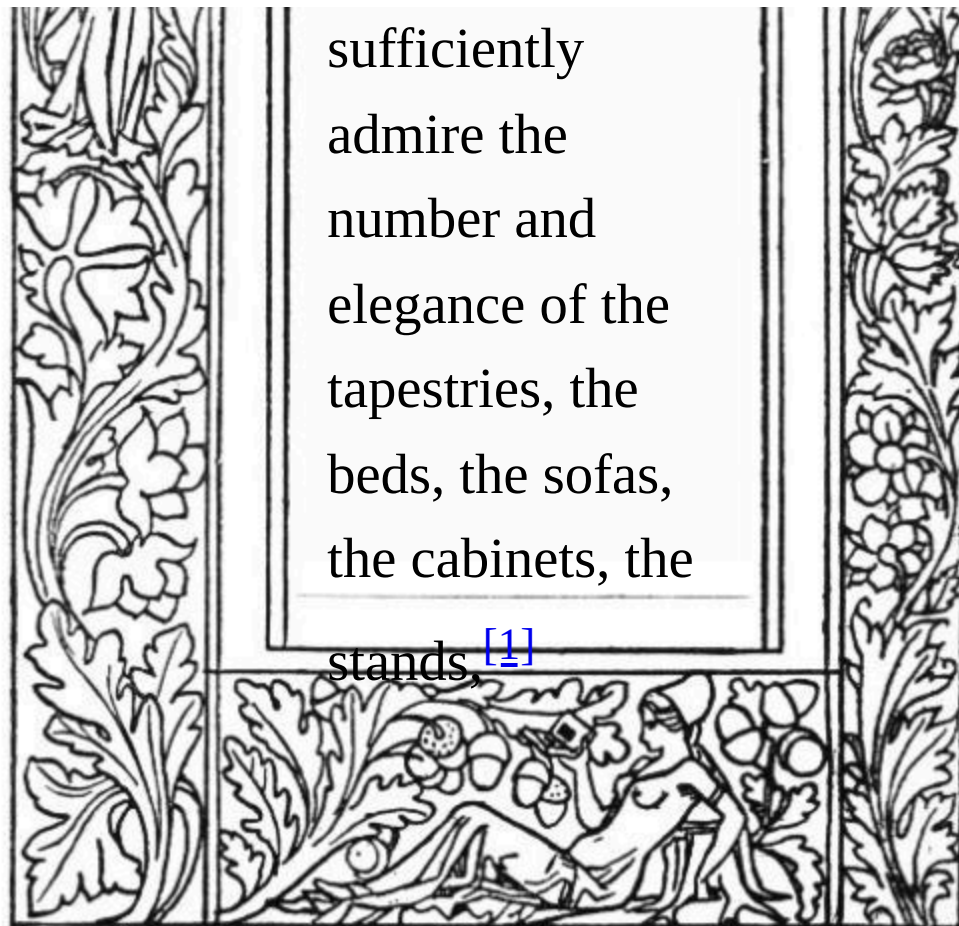


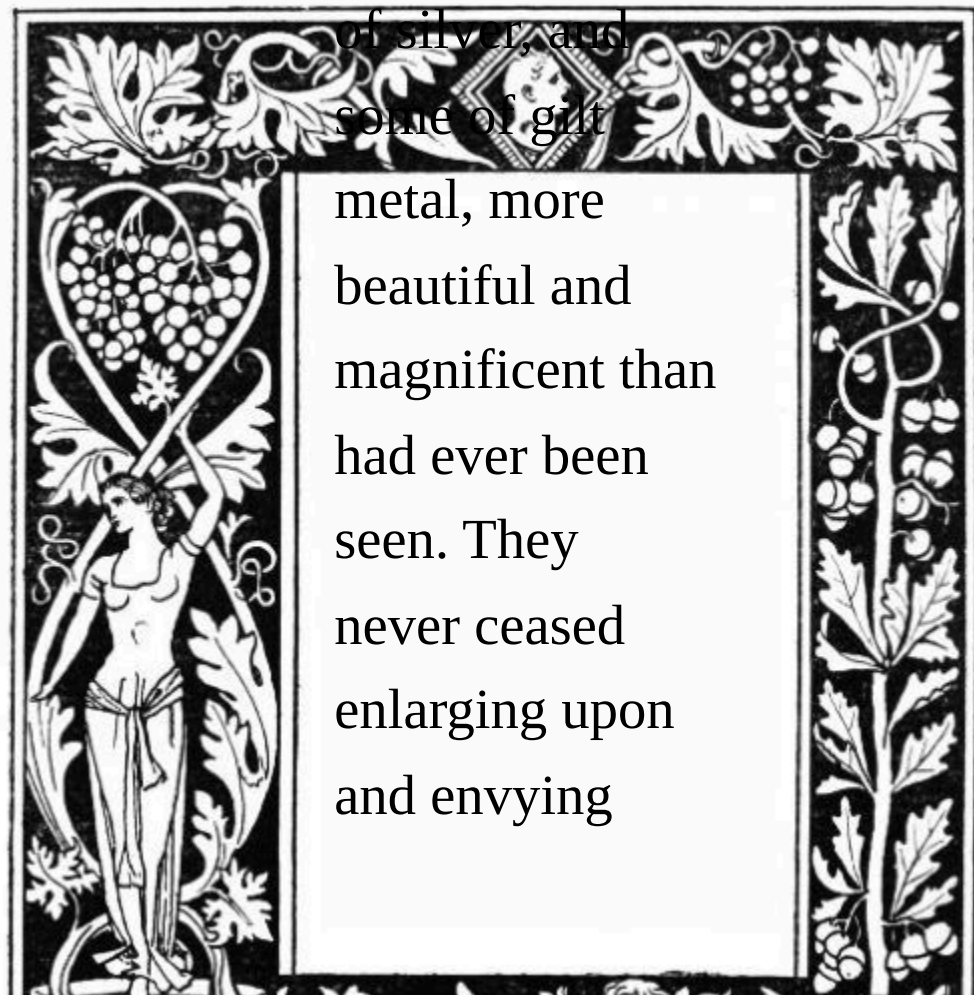
was at home, so
terrified were
they at his blue
beard.



Behold them
immediately
running through
all the rooms,
closets, and
wardrobes, each
apartment
exceeding the
other in beauty
and richness.

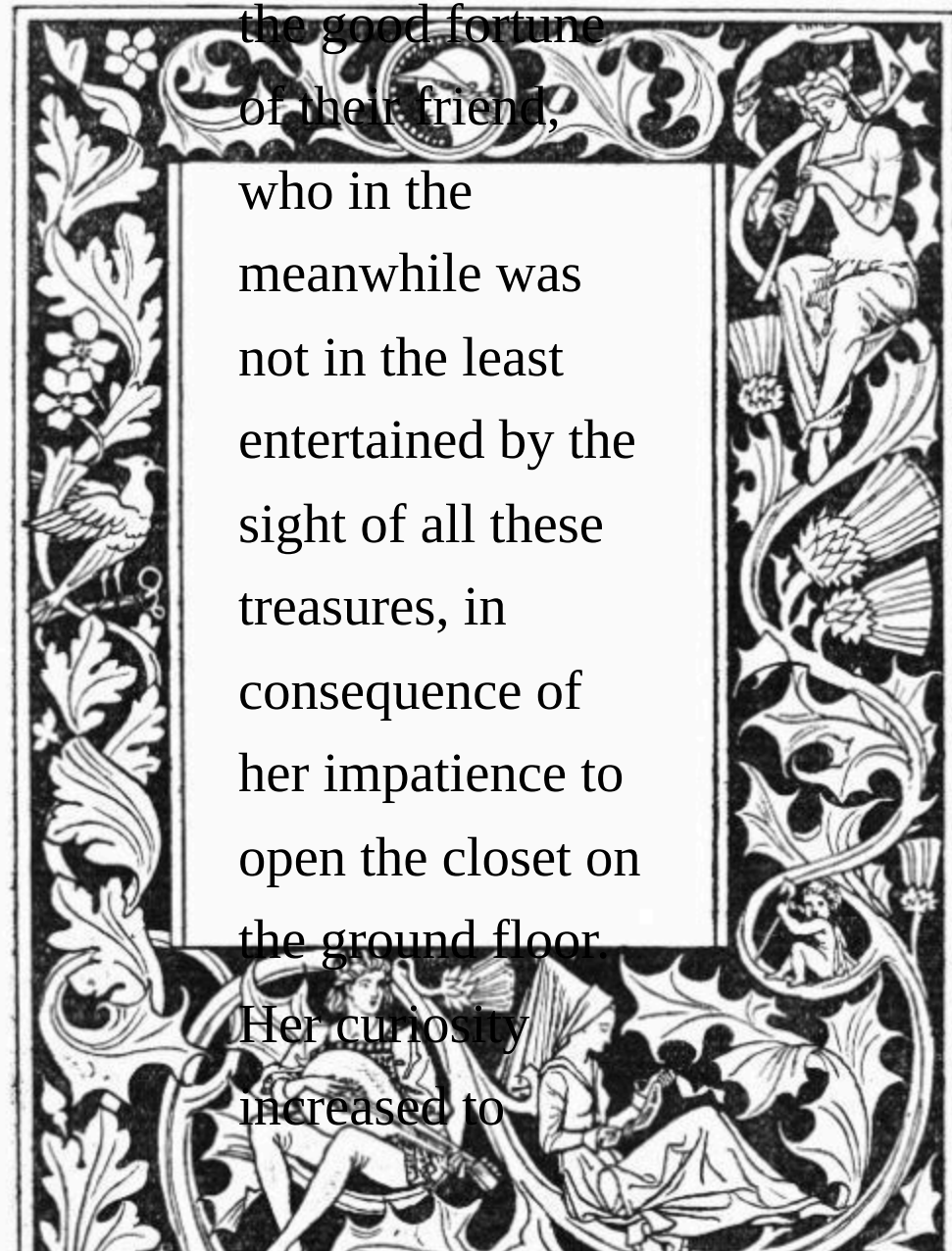


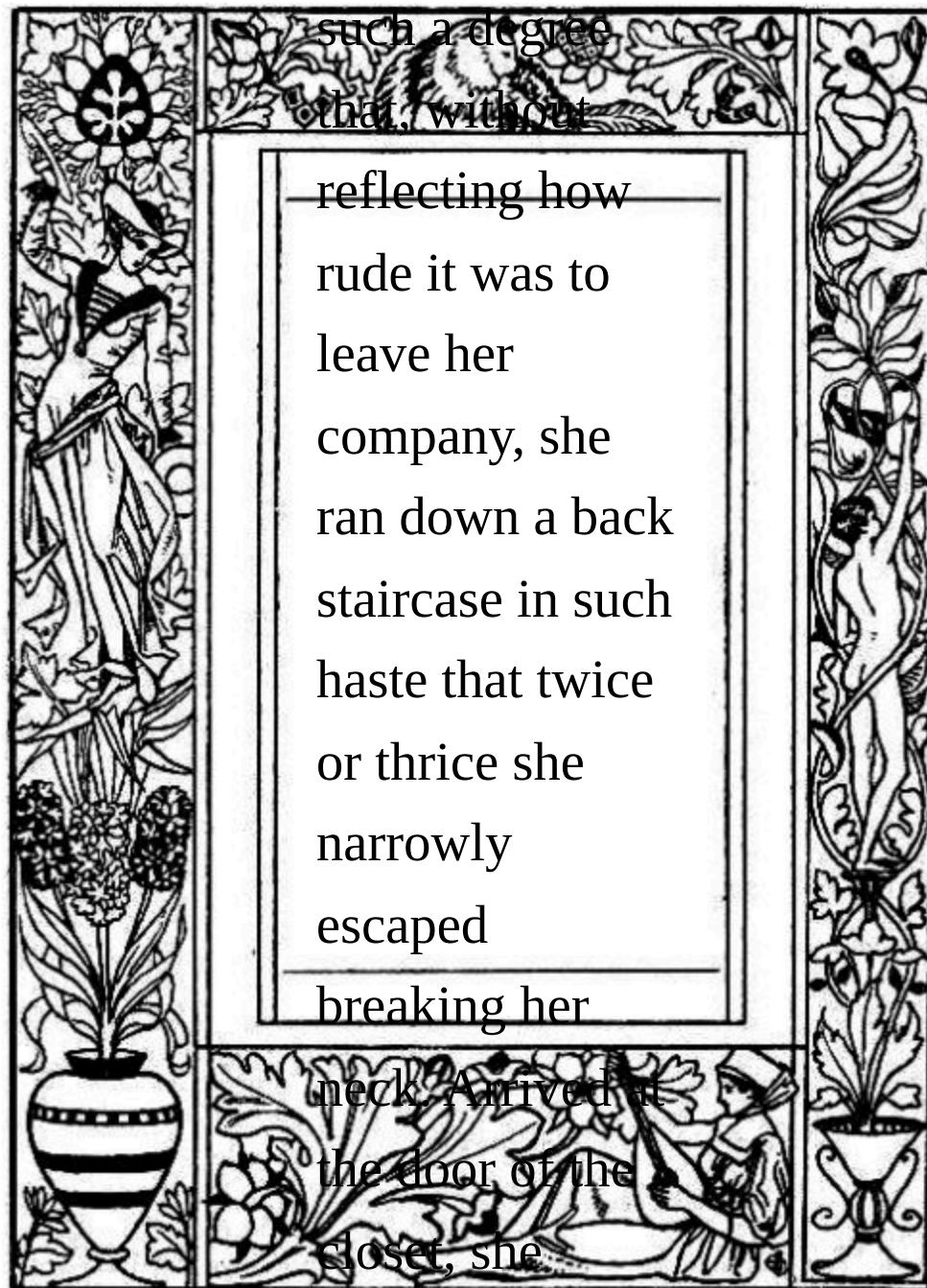






the good fortune
of their friend,
who in the
meanwhile was
not in the least
entertained by the
sight of all these
treasures, in
consequence of
her impatience to
open the closet on
the ground floor.
Her curiosity
increased to







paused for a
moment,

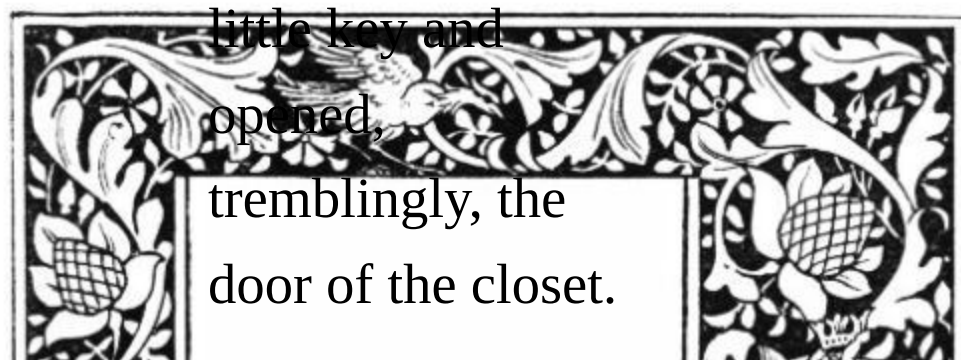
bethinking herself
of her husband's
prohibition, and
that some
misfortune might
befall her for her
disobedience; but
the temptation was
so strong that she
could not conquer
it. She therefore



took the



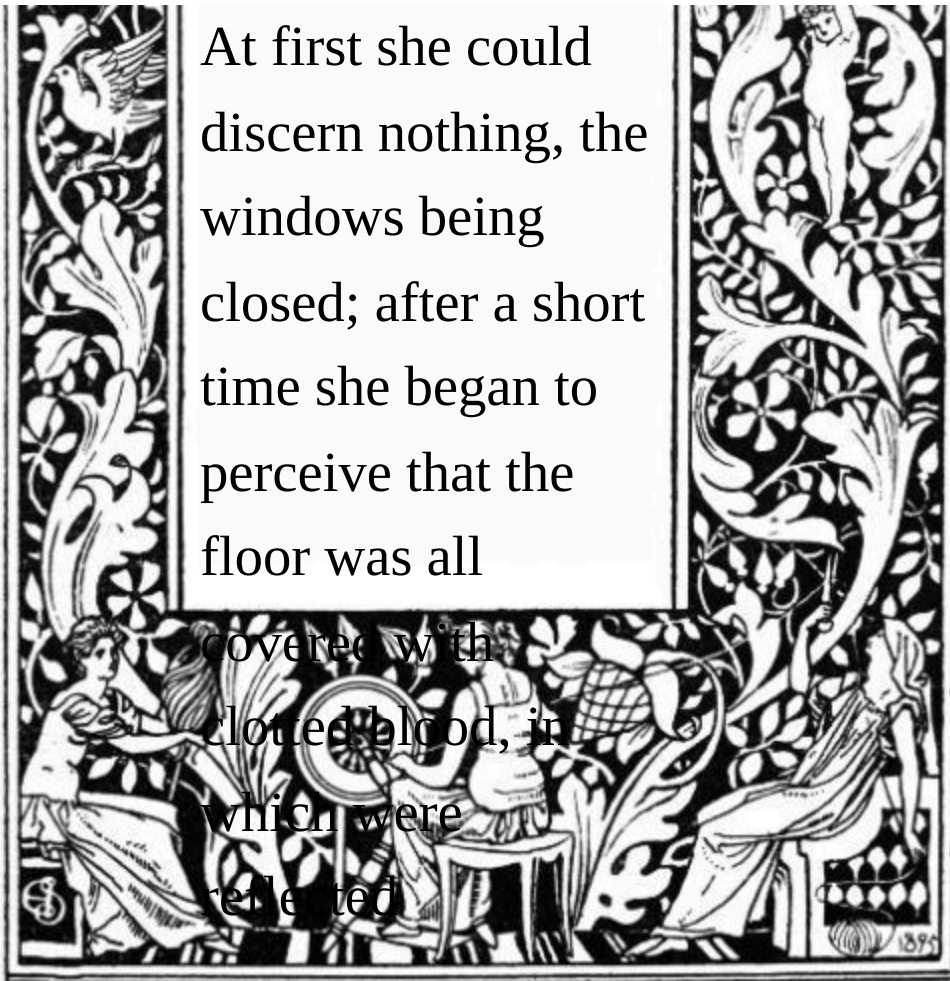
She paused before unlocking the door



little key and
opened,
tremblingly, the
door of the closet.

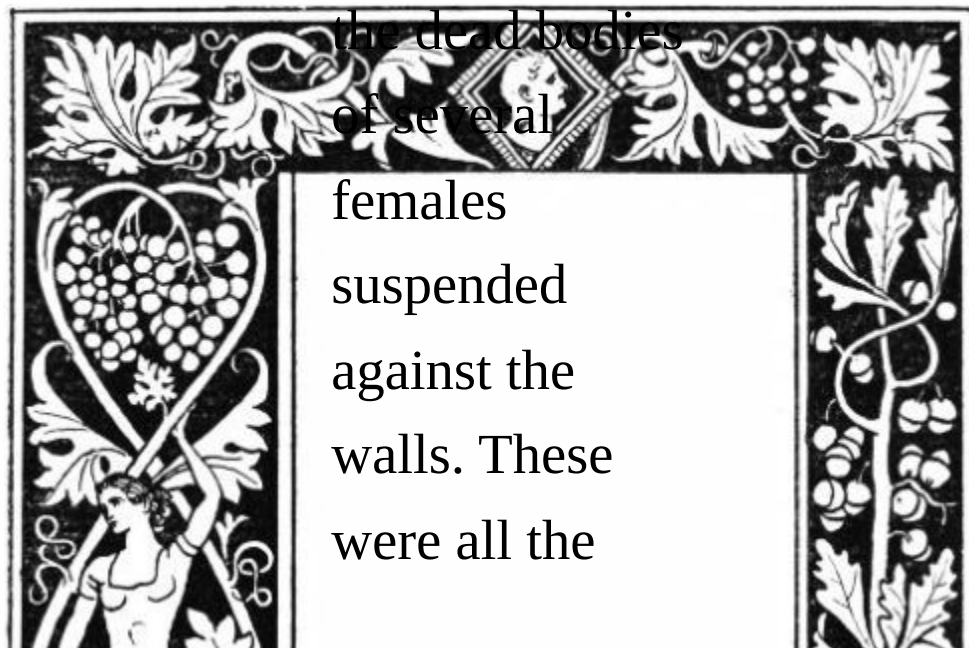
At first she could discern nothing, the windows being closed; after a short time she began to perceive that the floor was all

covered with
clotted blood, in
which were
reflected



the dead bodies
of several

females
suspended
against the
walls. These
were all the





wives of Blue
Beard, who had
cut their throats
one after the

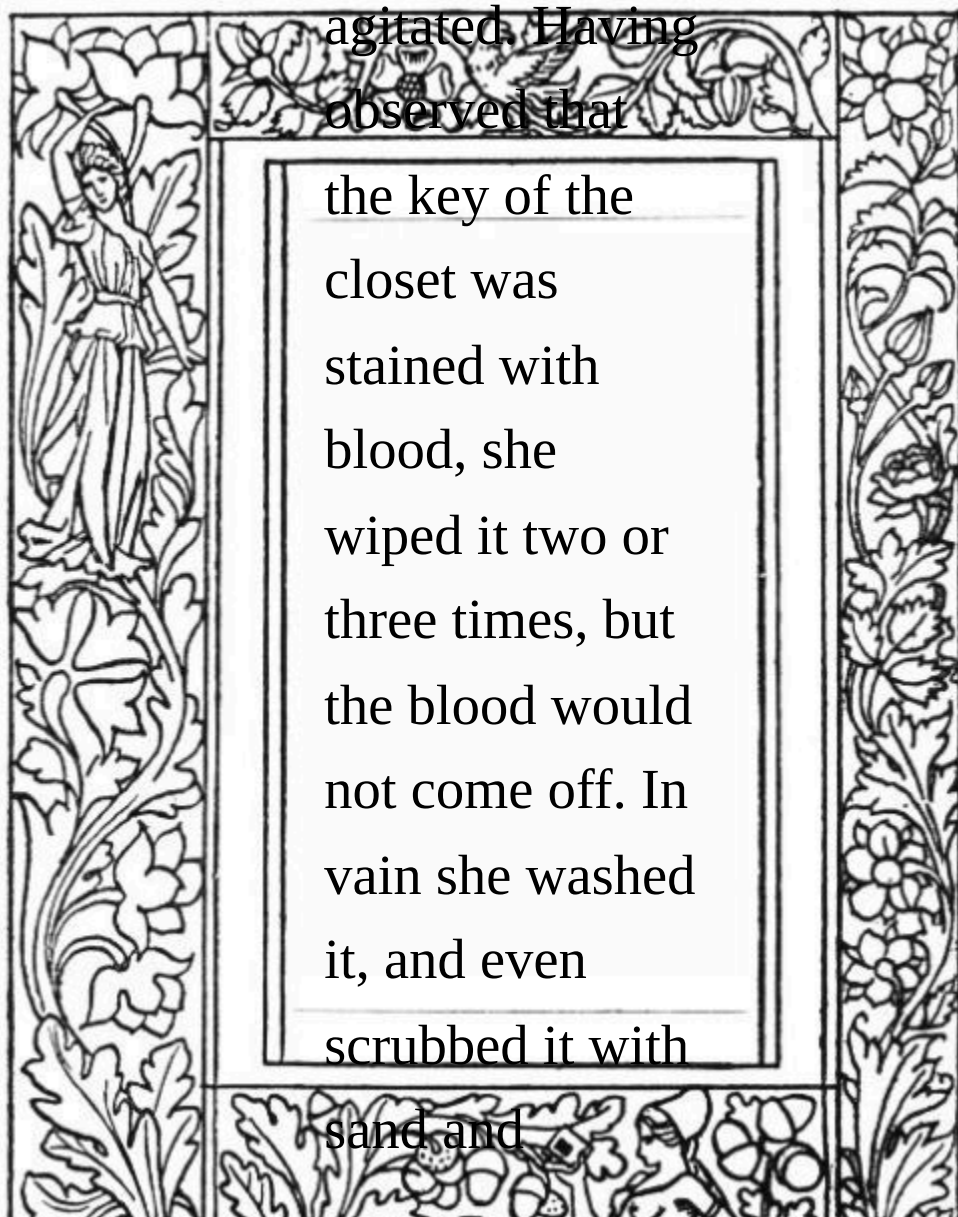
other. She was
ready to die with
fright, and the
key of the

closet, which

had withdrawn
from the lock, fell
from her hand.

After recovering
her senses a little,
she picked up the
key, locked the
door again, and
went up to her
chamber to
compose herself;



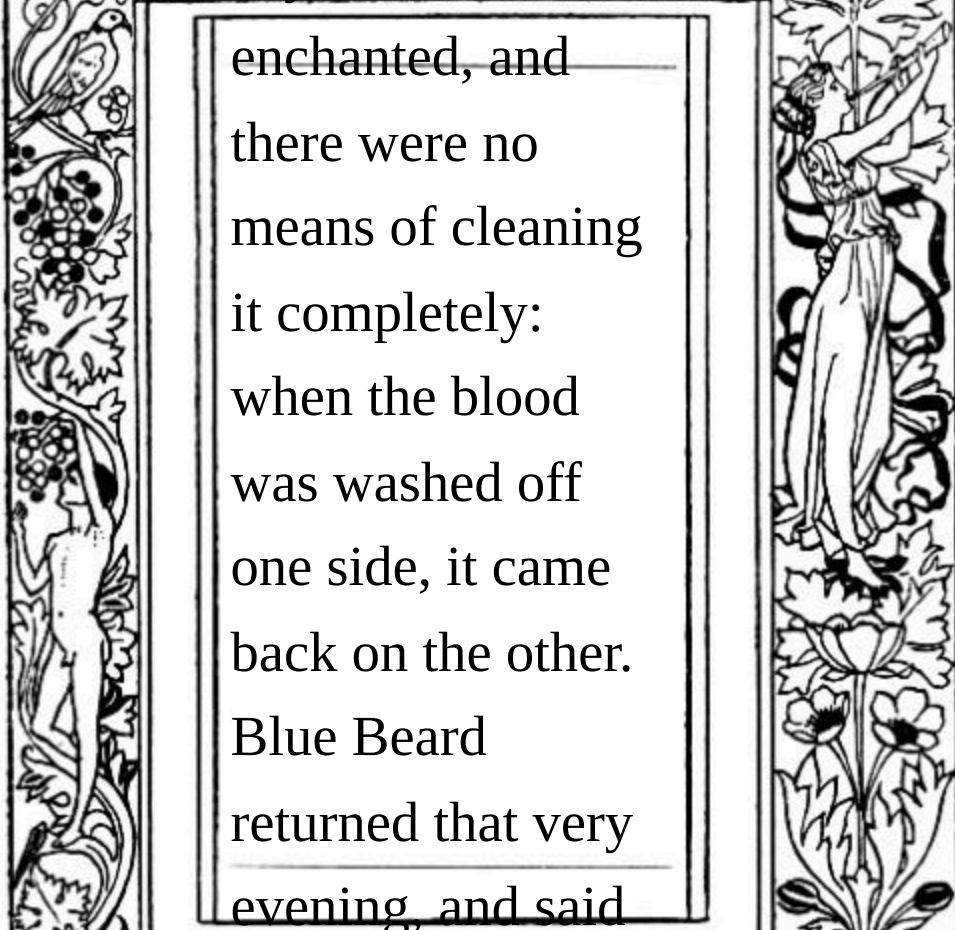




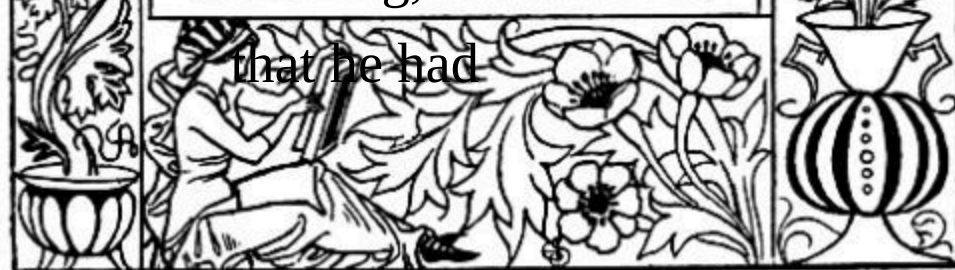
freestone, the
blood was



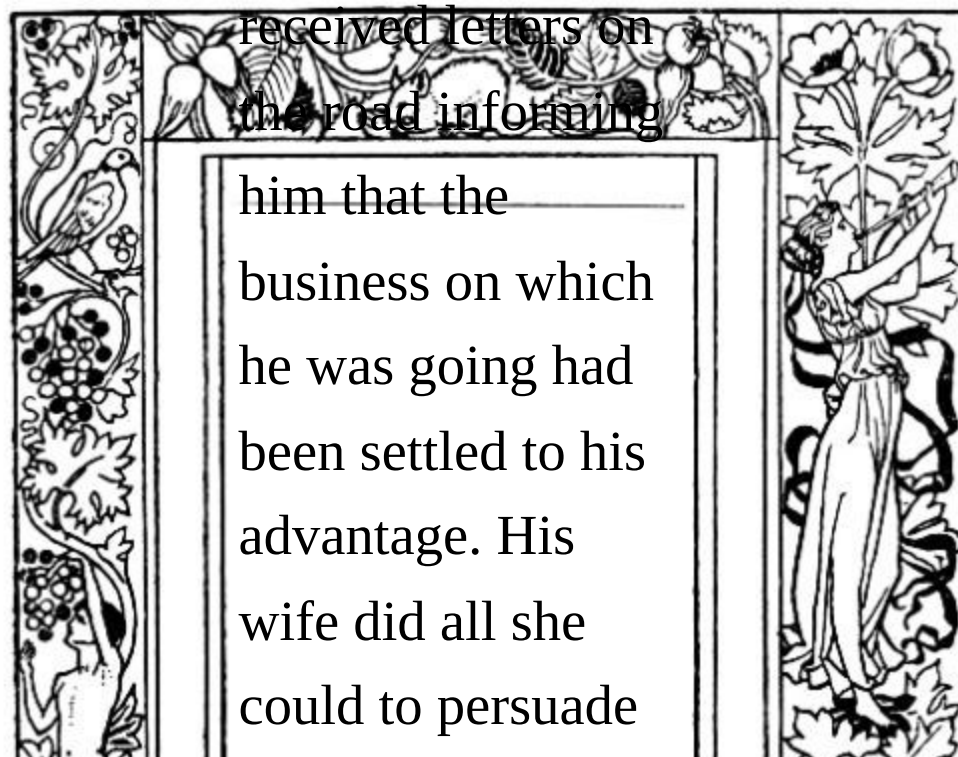
still there, for the
key was

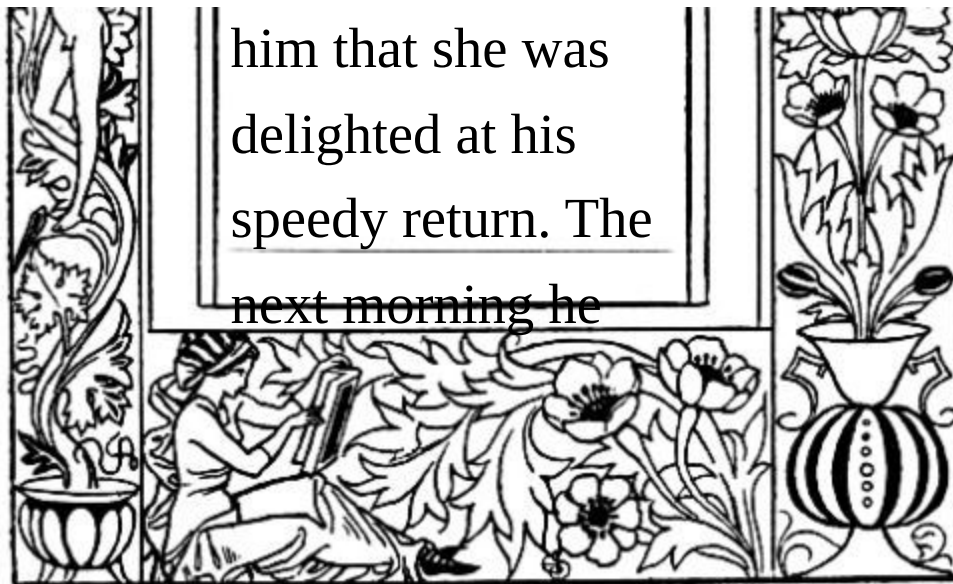


enchanted, and
there were no
means of cleaning
it completely:
when the blood
was washed off
one side, it came
back on the other.
Blue Beard
returned that very
evening, and said

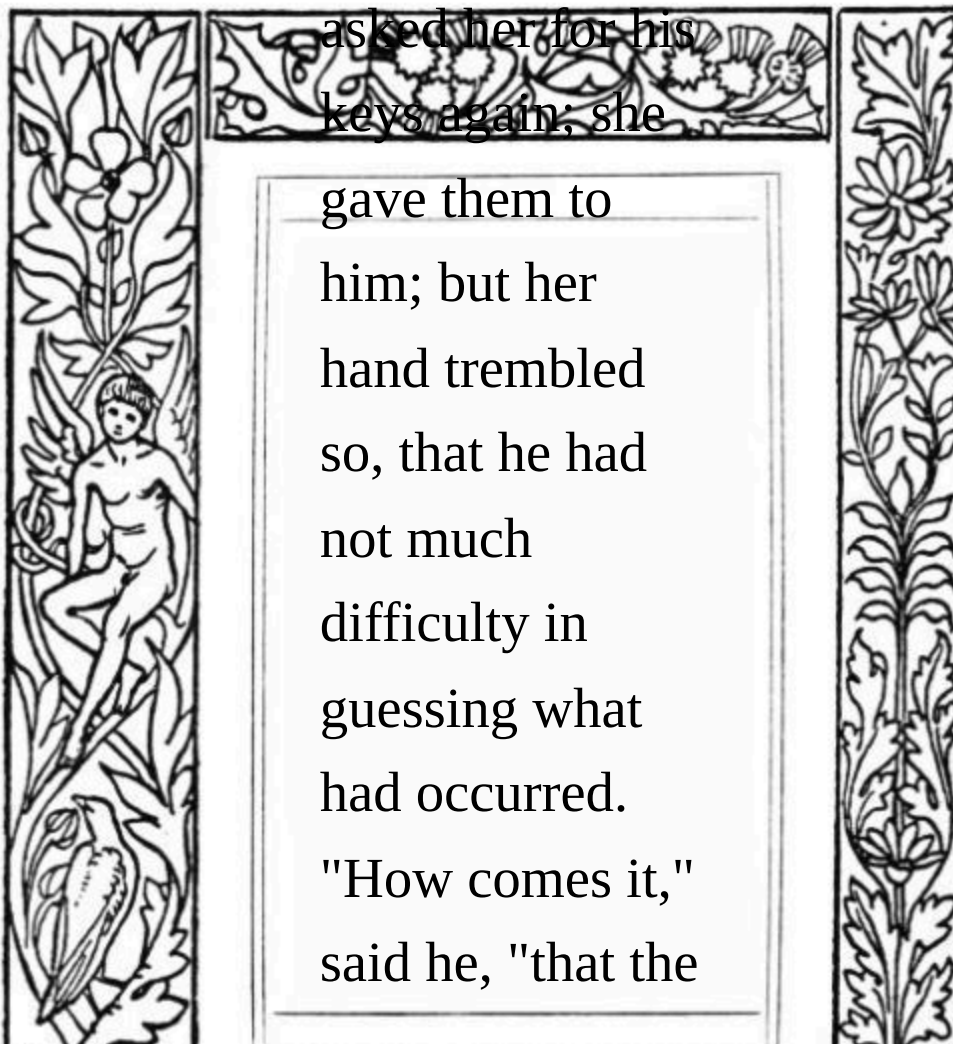


that he had



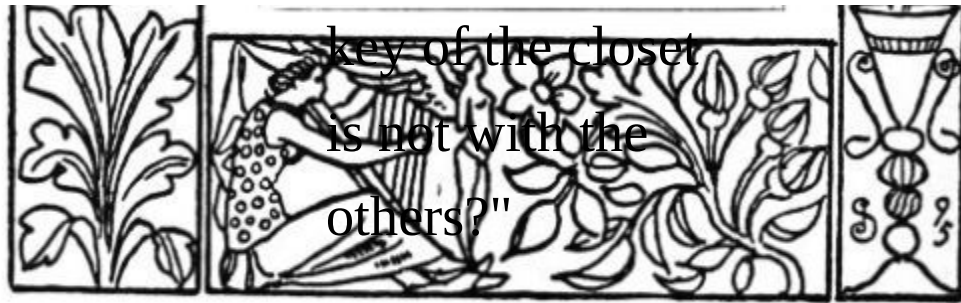


him that she was
delighted at his
speedy return. The
next morning he

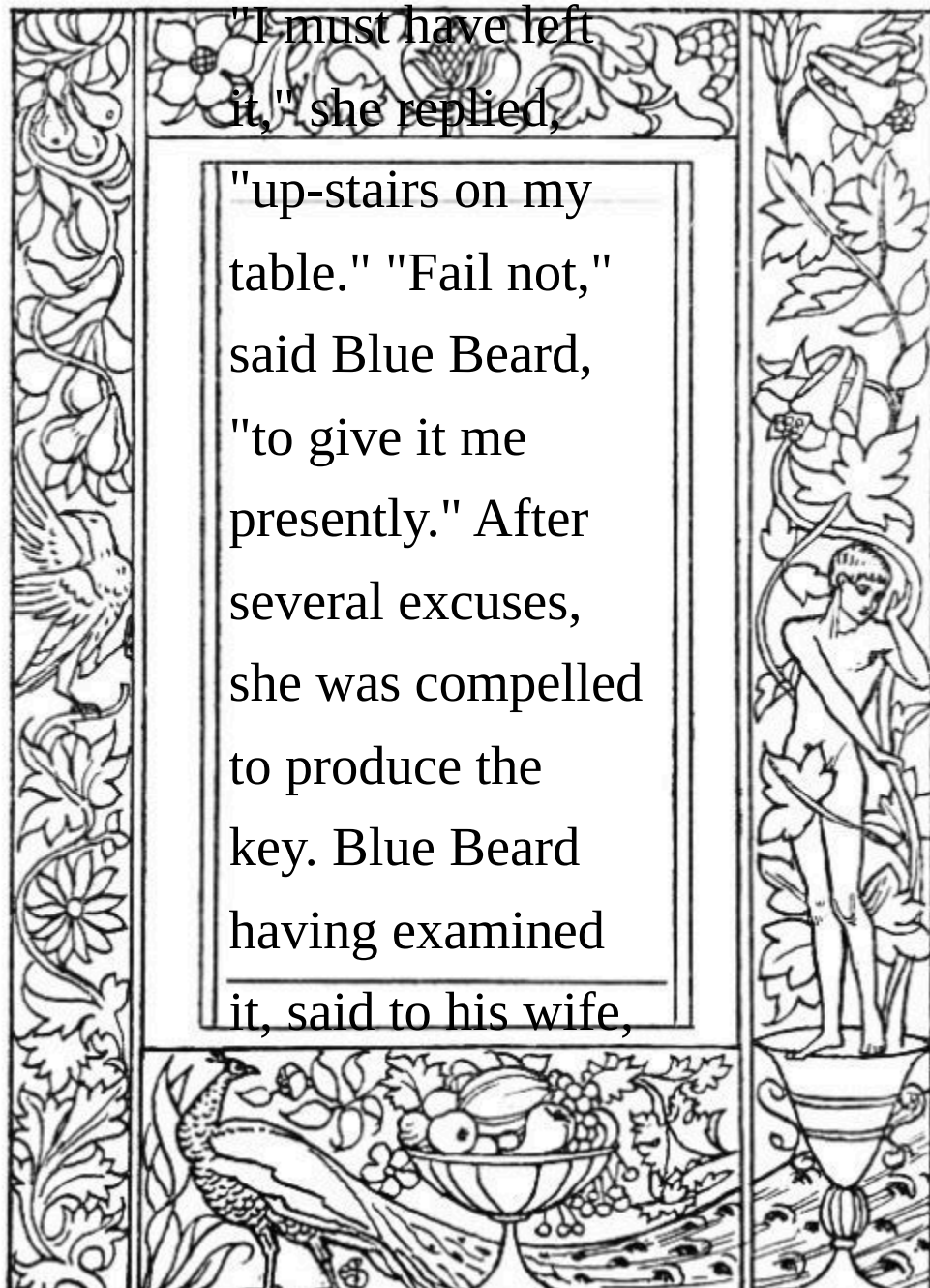


asked her for his
keys again; she

gave them to
him; but her
hand trembled
so, that he had
not much
difficulty in
guessing what
had occurred.
"How comes it,"
said he, "that the

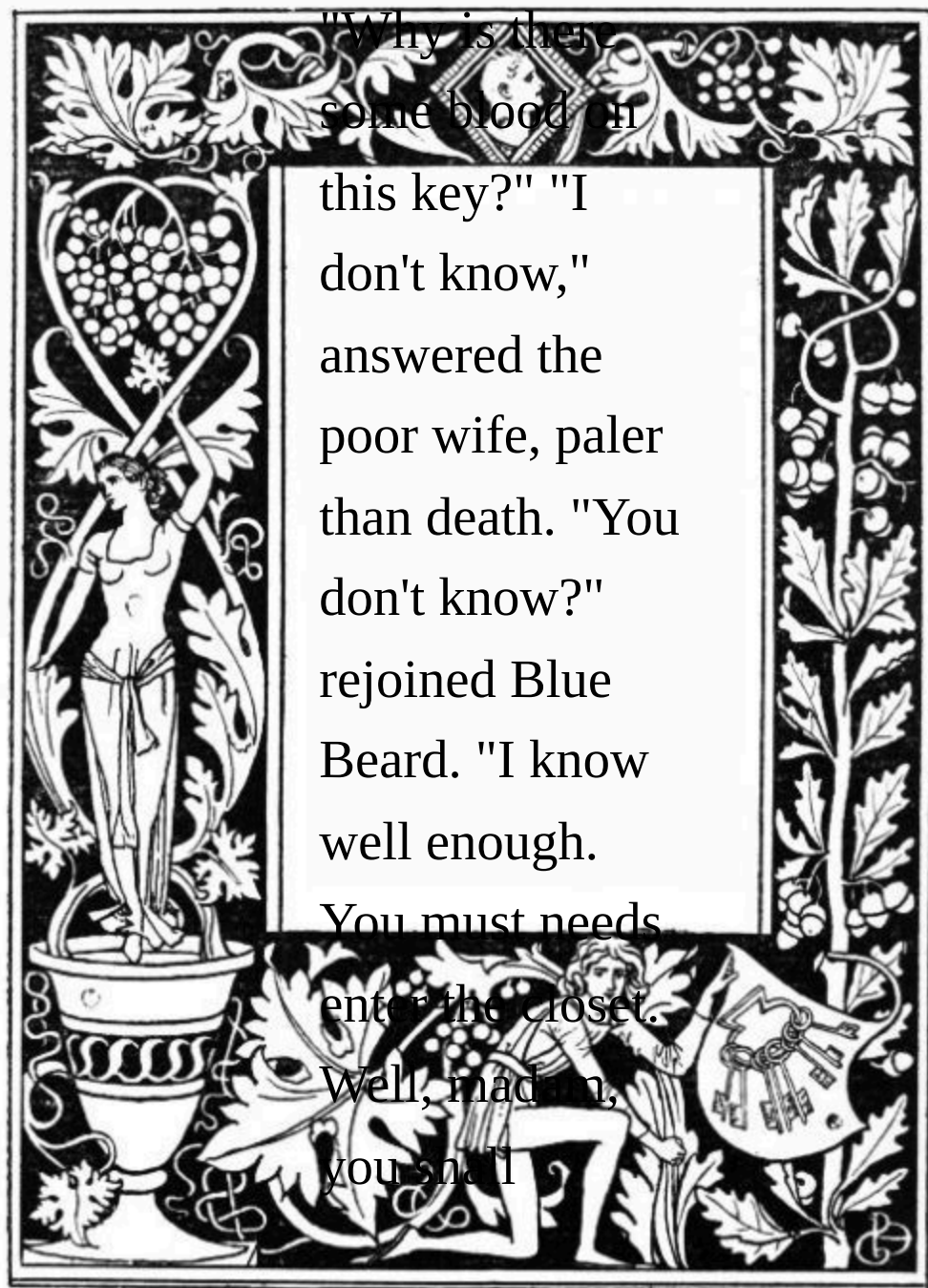


key of the closet
is not with the
others?"



"I must have left
it," she replied,

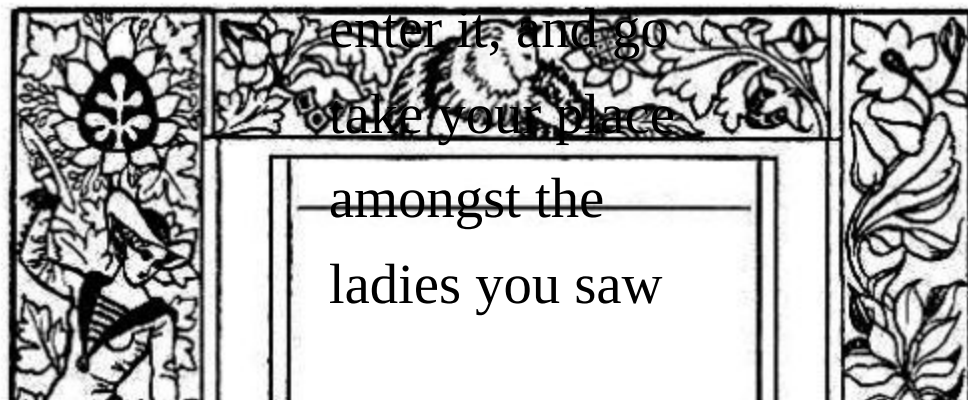
"up-stairs on my
table." "Fail not,"
said Blue Beard,
"to give it me
presently." After
several excuses,
she was compelled
to produce the
key. Blue Beard
having examined
it, said to his wife,

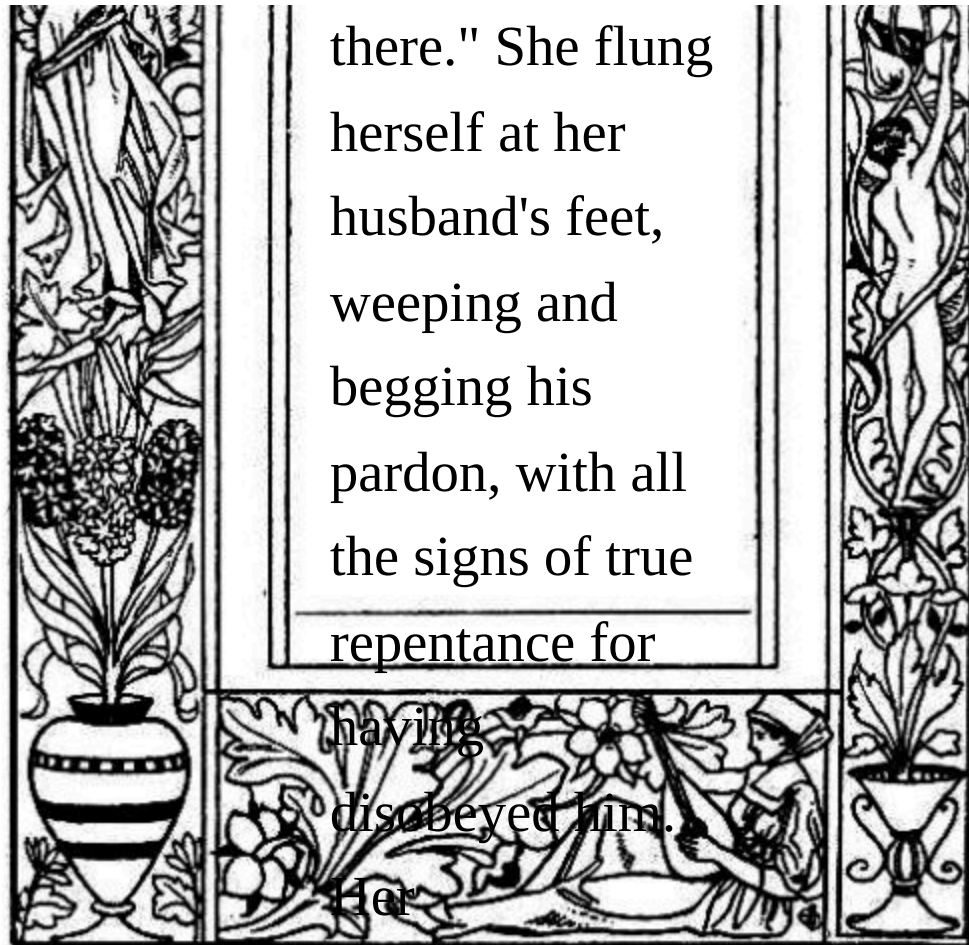


"Why is there
some blood on

this key?" "I
don't know,"
answered the
poor wife, paler
than death. "You
don't know?"
rejoined Blue
Beard. "I know
well enough.

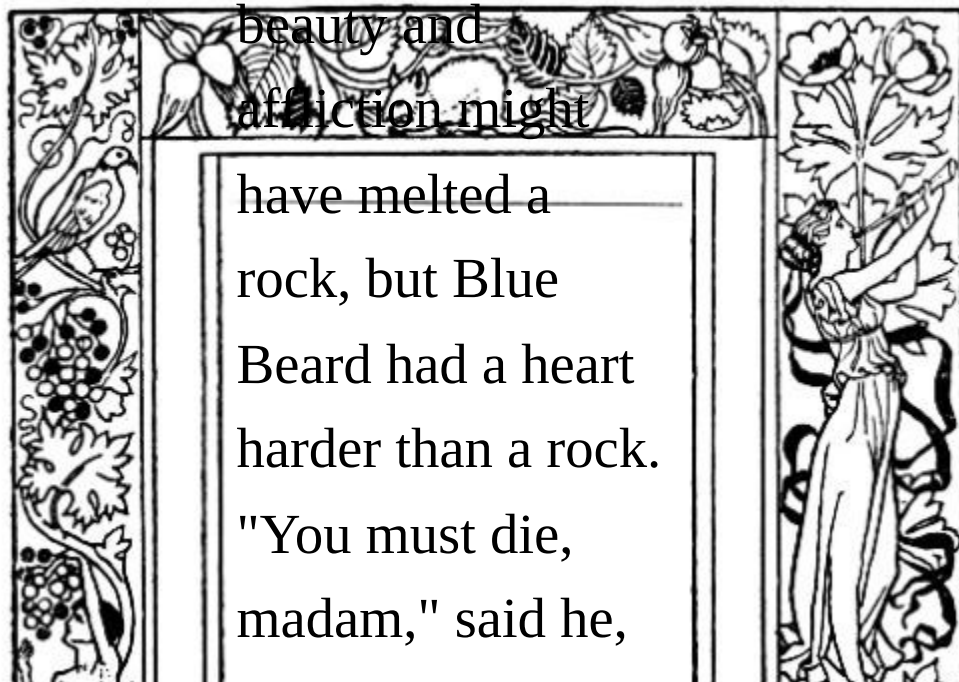
You must needs
enter the closet.
Well, madam,
you shall





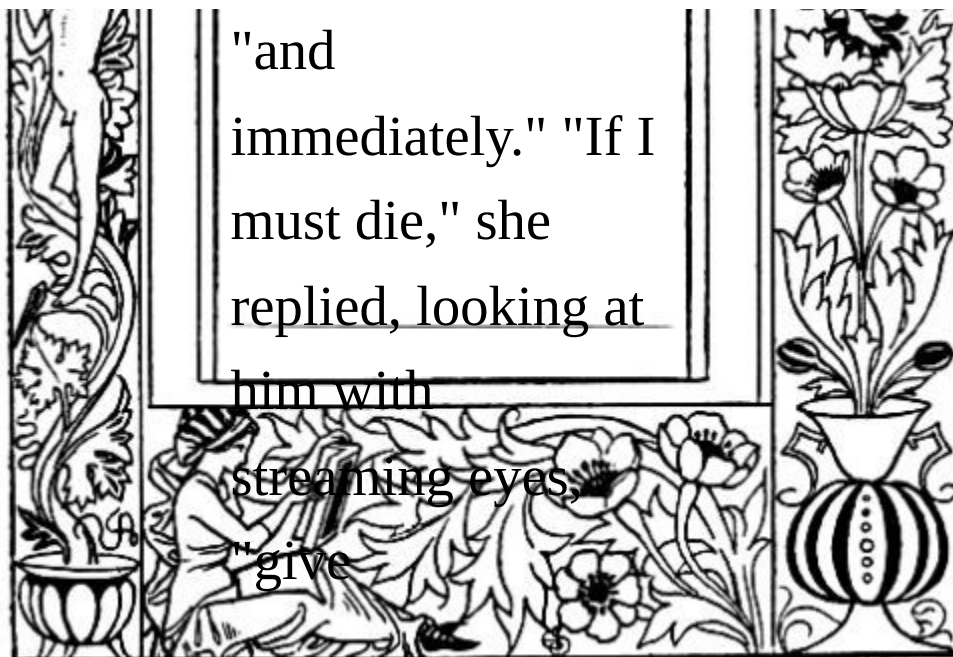
there." She flung herself at her husband's feet, weeping and begging his pardon, with all the signs of true repentance for

having disobeyed him.
Her

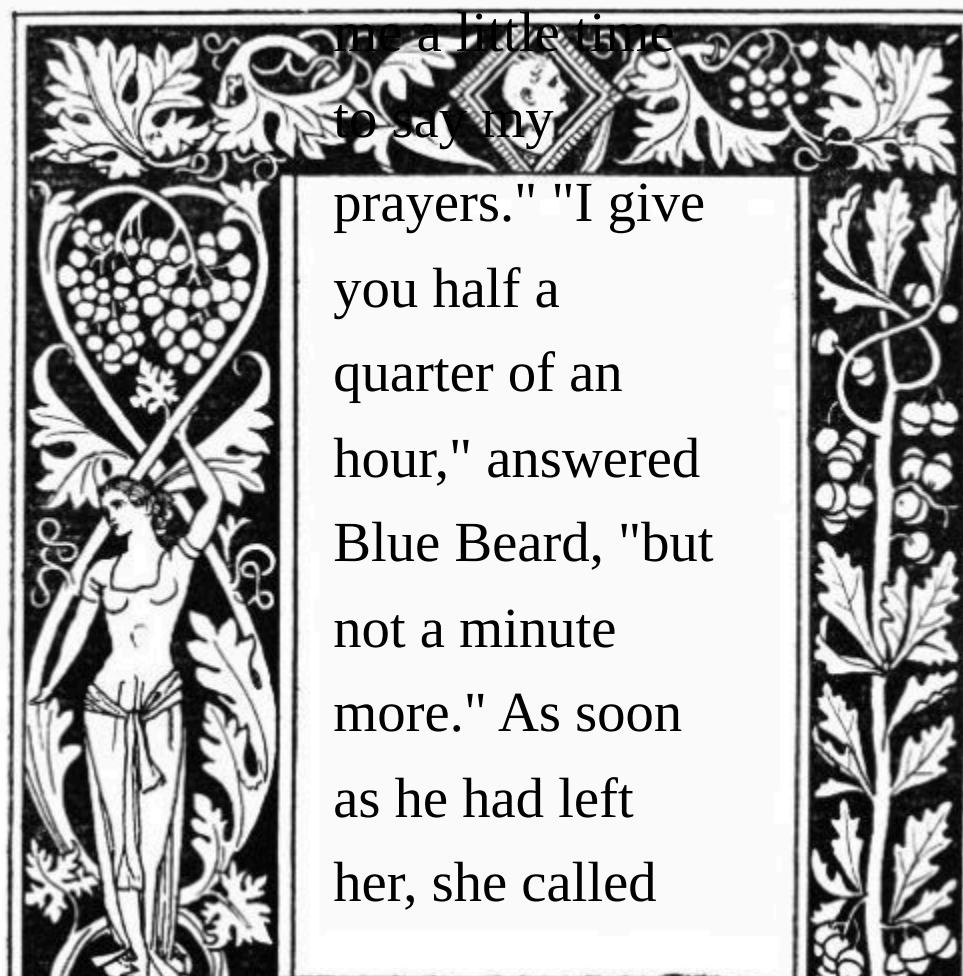


beauty and
affliction might

have melted a rock, but Blue Beard had a heart harder than a rock. "You must die, madam," said he,



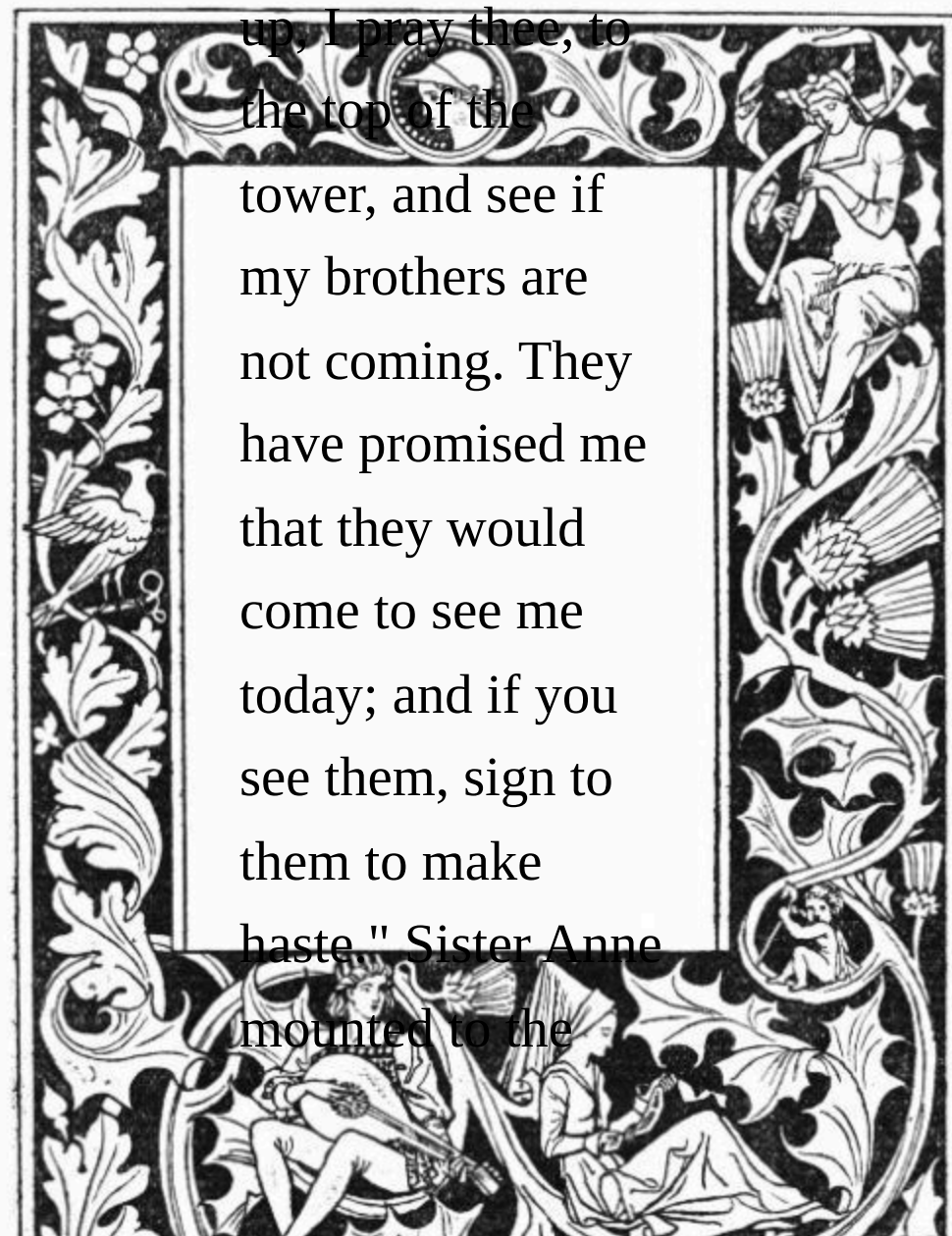
"and
immediately." "If I
must die," she
replied, looking at
him with
streaming eyes,
"give



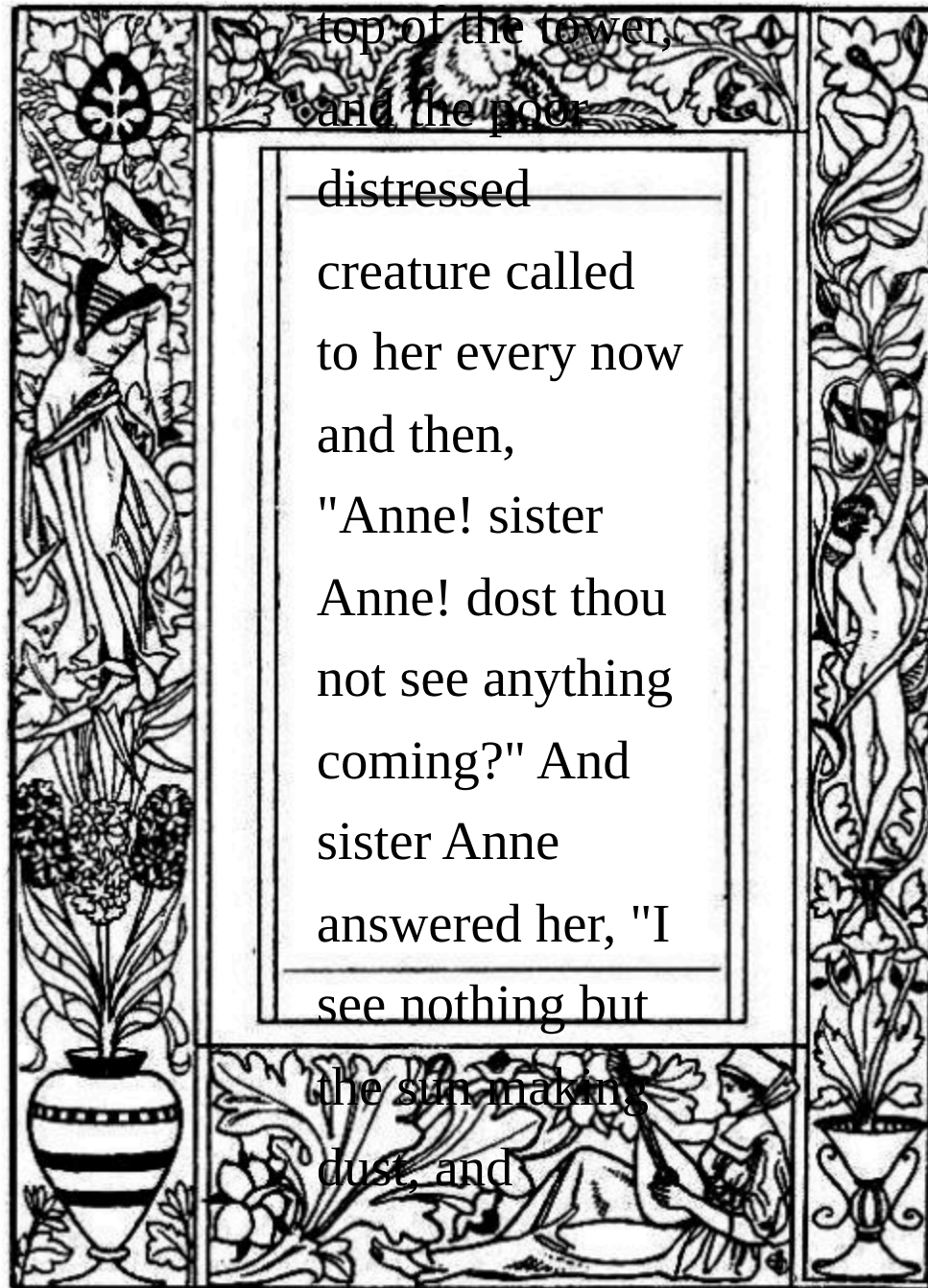
me a little time
to say my
prayers." "I give
you half a
quarter of an
hour," answered
Blue Beard, "but
not a minute
more." As soon
as he had left
her, she called



her sister, and
said to her,
"Sister Anne"
(for so she was
named), "go



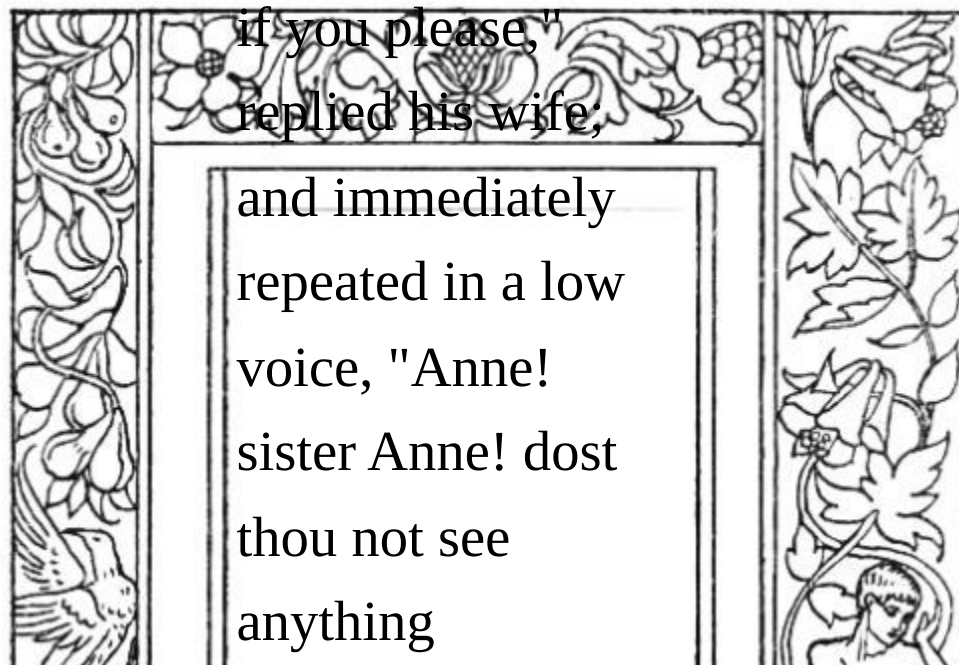
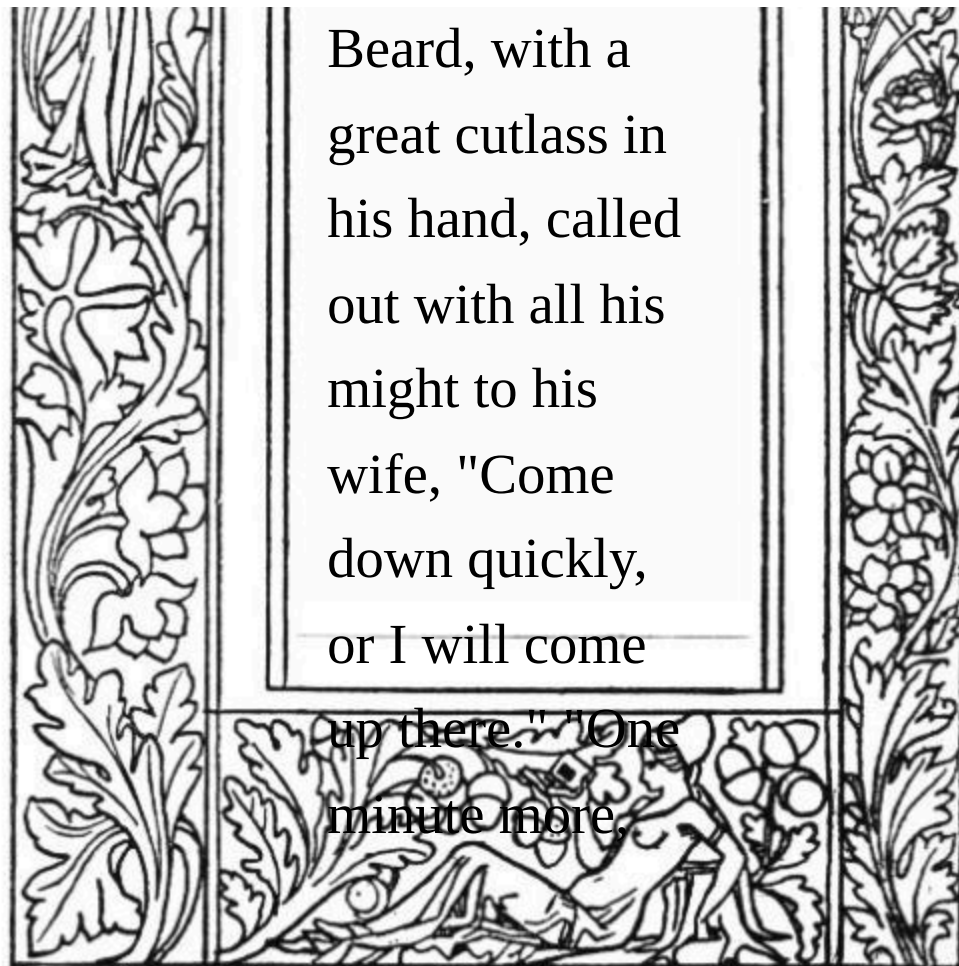
up, I pray thee, to
the top of the
tower, and see if
my brothers are
not coming. They
have promised me
that they would
come to see me
today; and if you
see them, sign to
them to make
haste." Sister Anne
mounted to the

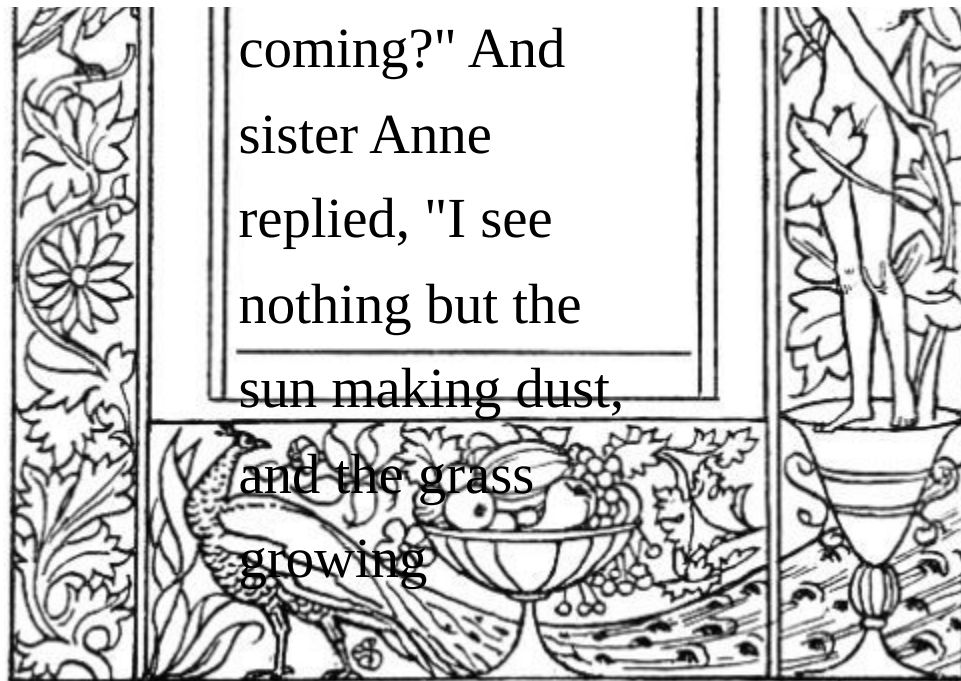




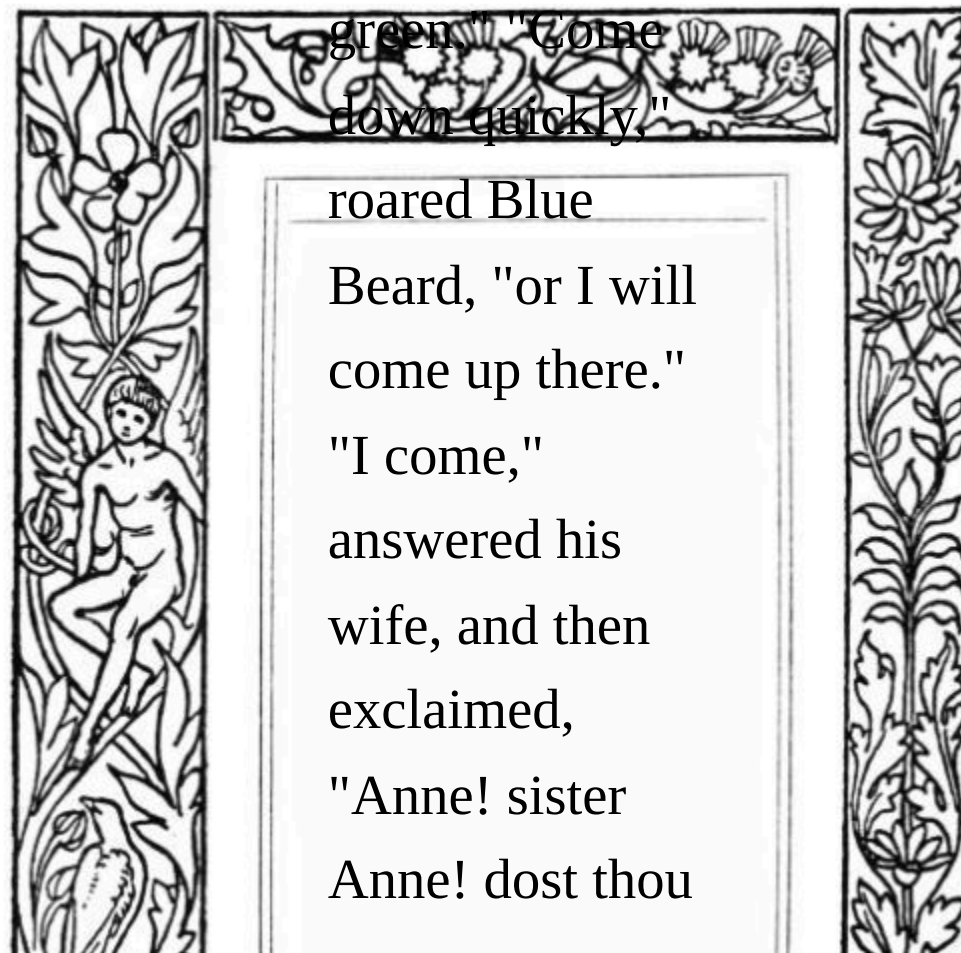
the grass
growing green."

In the
meanwhile Blue



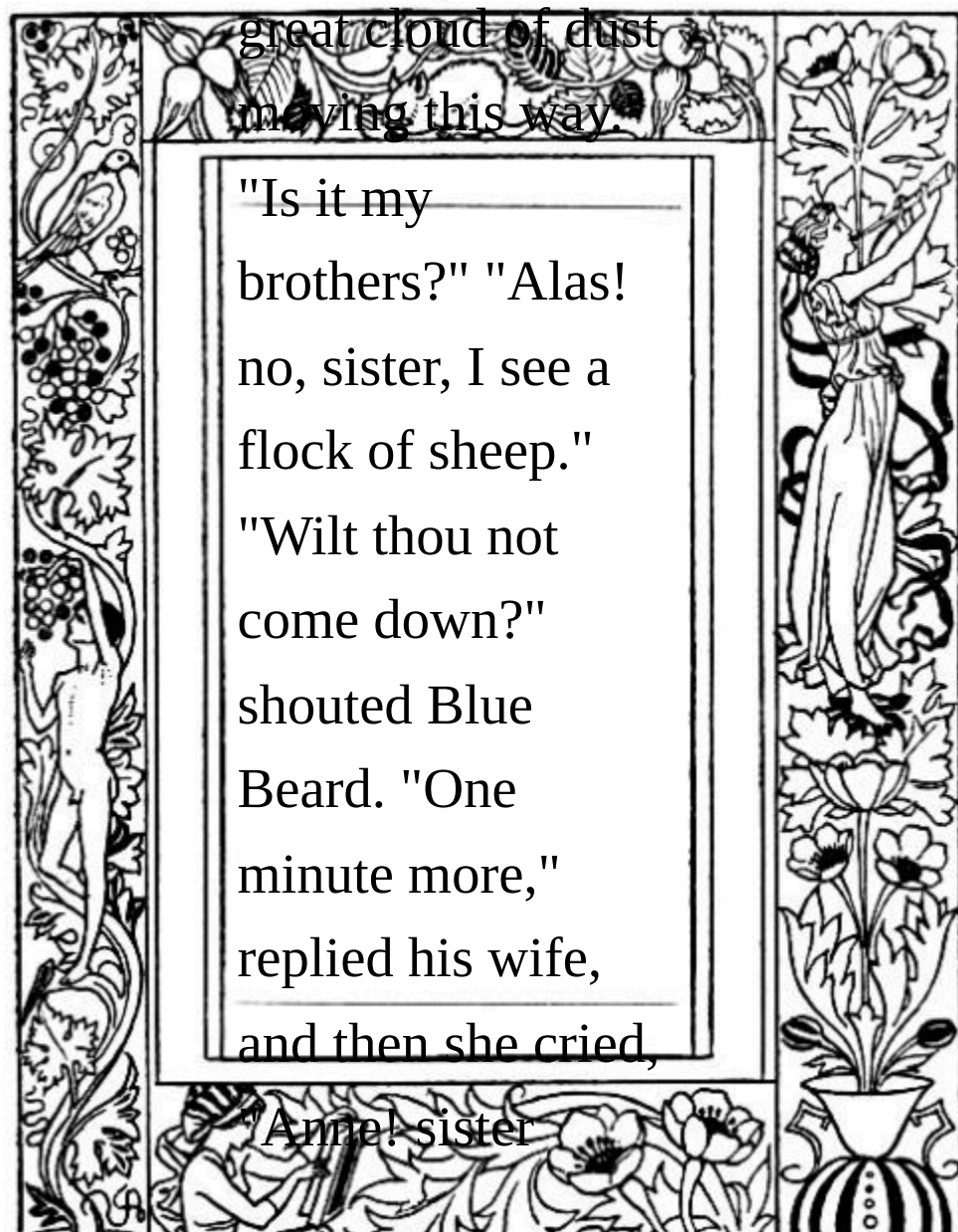


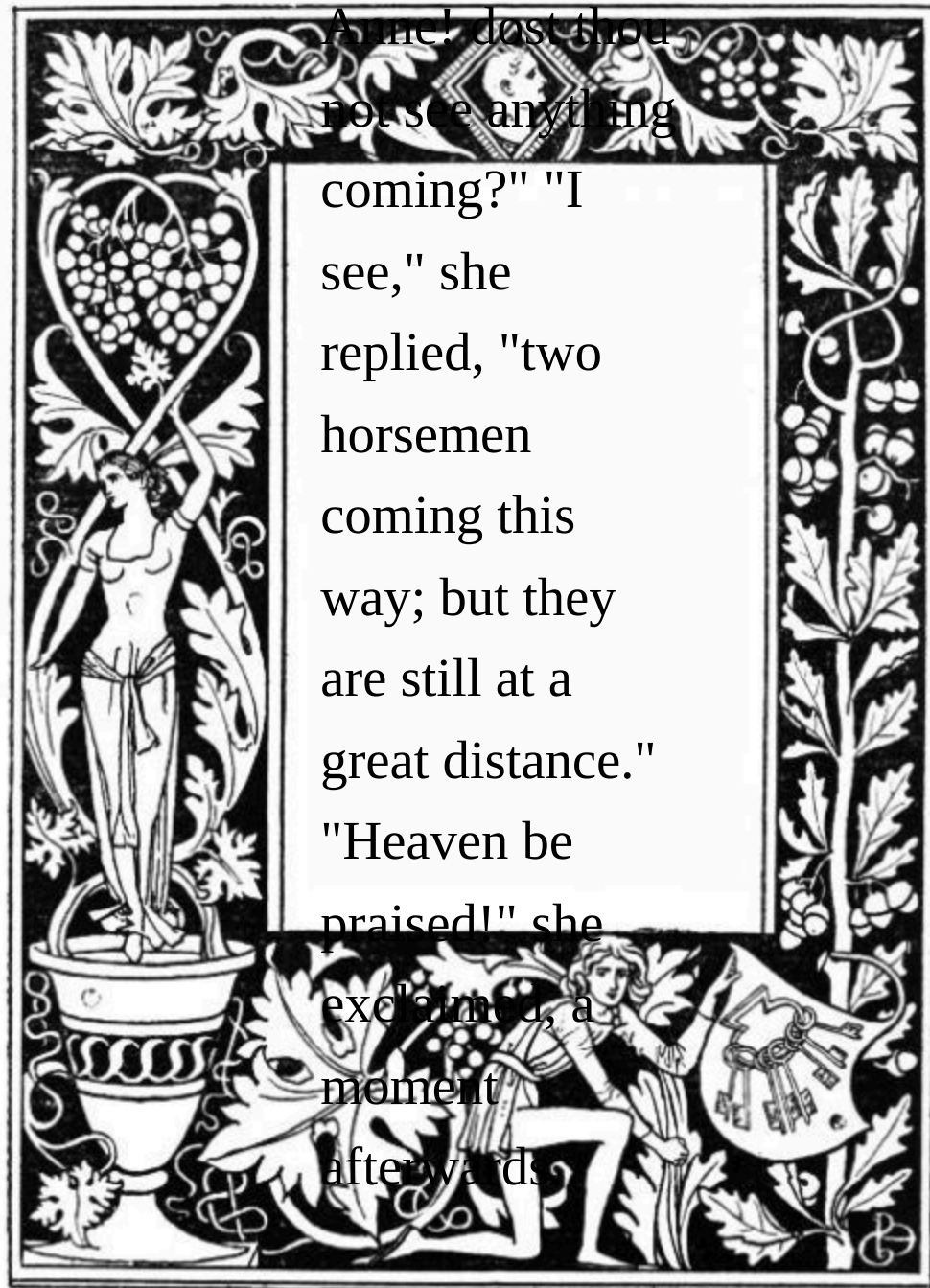
coming?" And
sister Anne
replied, "I see
nothing but the
sun making dust,
and the grass
growing



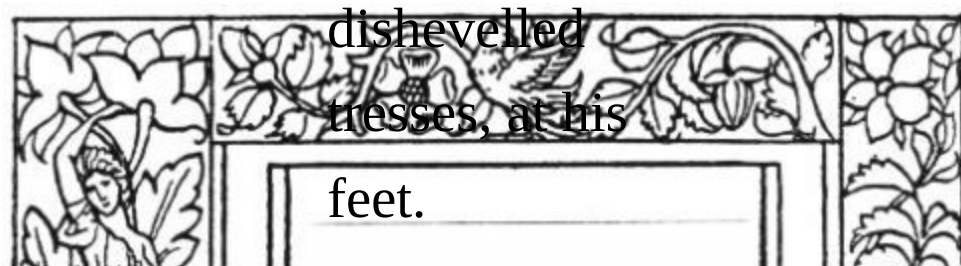
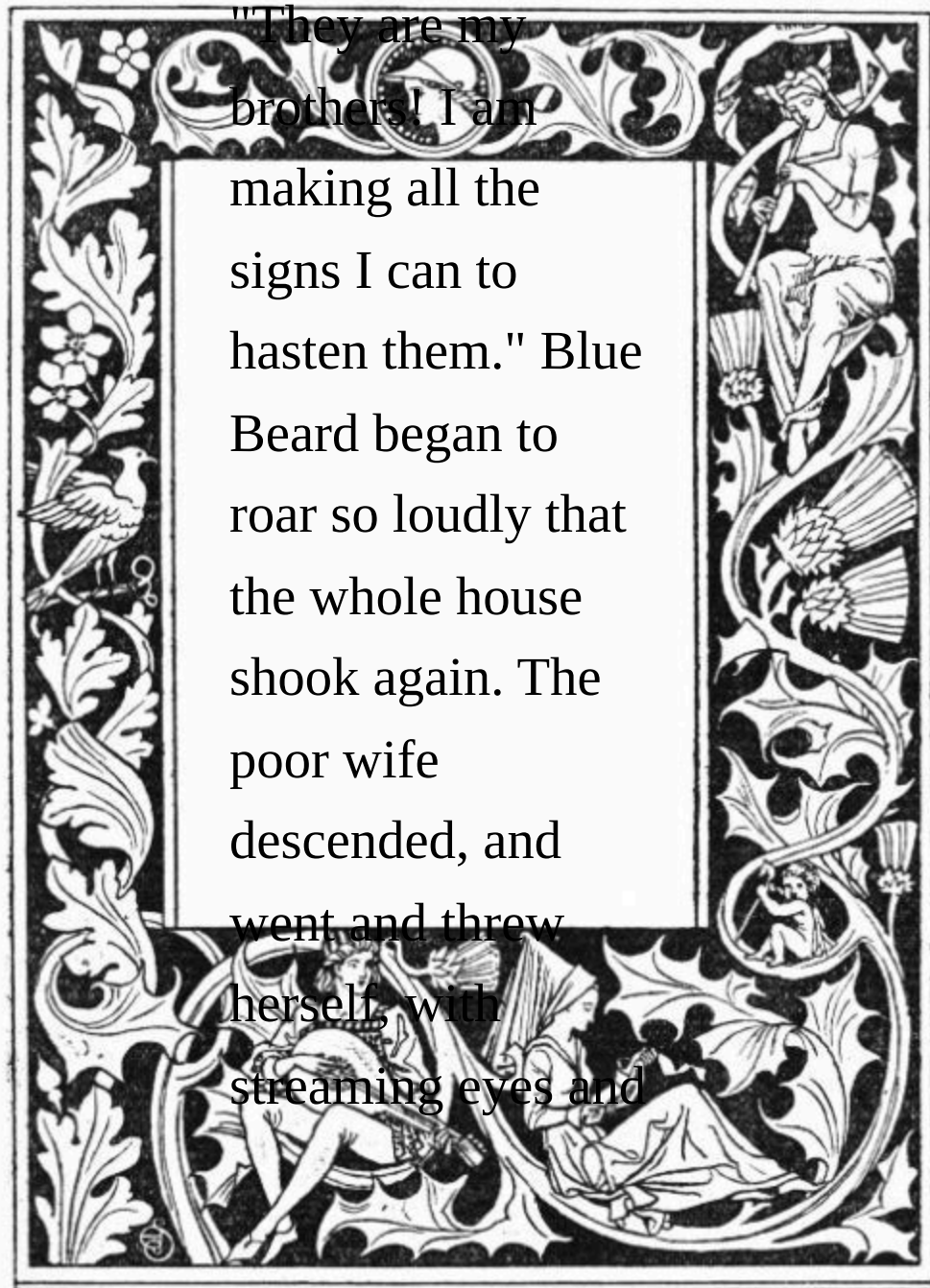
green." "Come
down quickly."

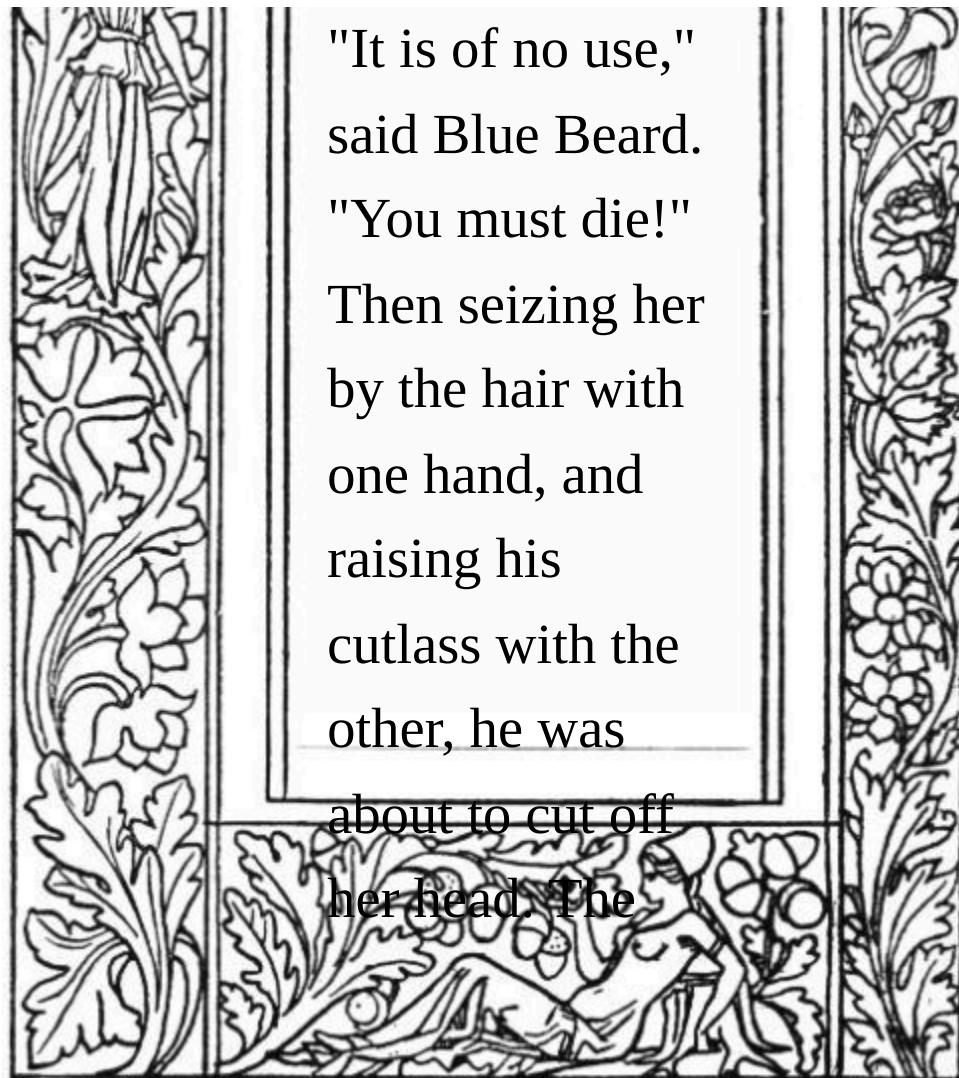
roared Blue
Beard, "or I will
come up there."
"I come,"
answered his
wife, and then
exclaimed,
"Anne! sister
Anne! dost thou





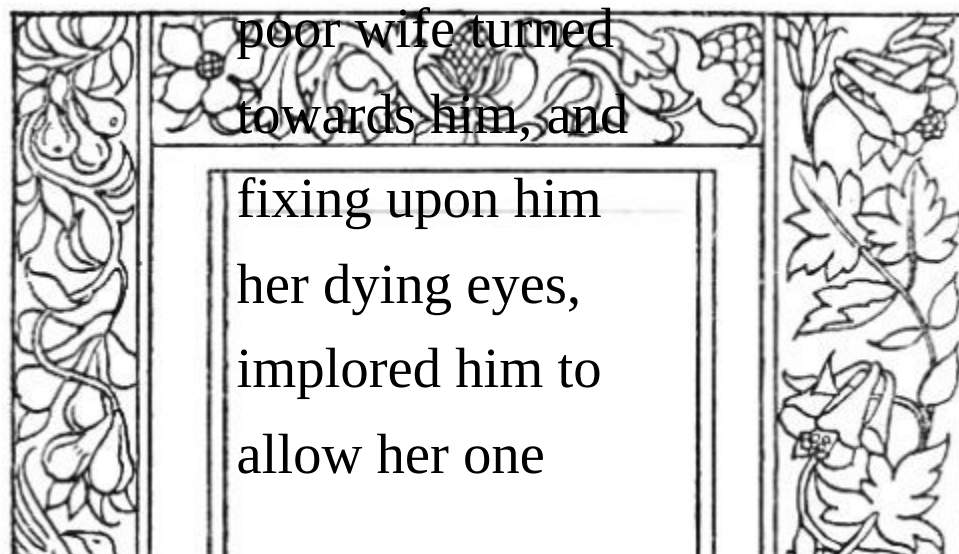
Anne! dost thou
not see anything
coming?" "I
see," she
replied, "two
horsemen
coming this
way; but they
are still at a
great distance."
"Heaven be
praised!" she
exclaimed, a
moment
afterwards.





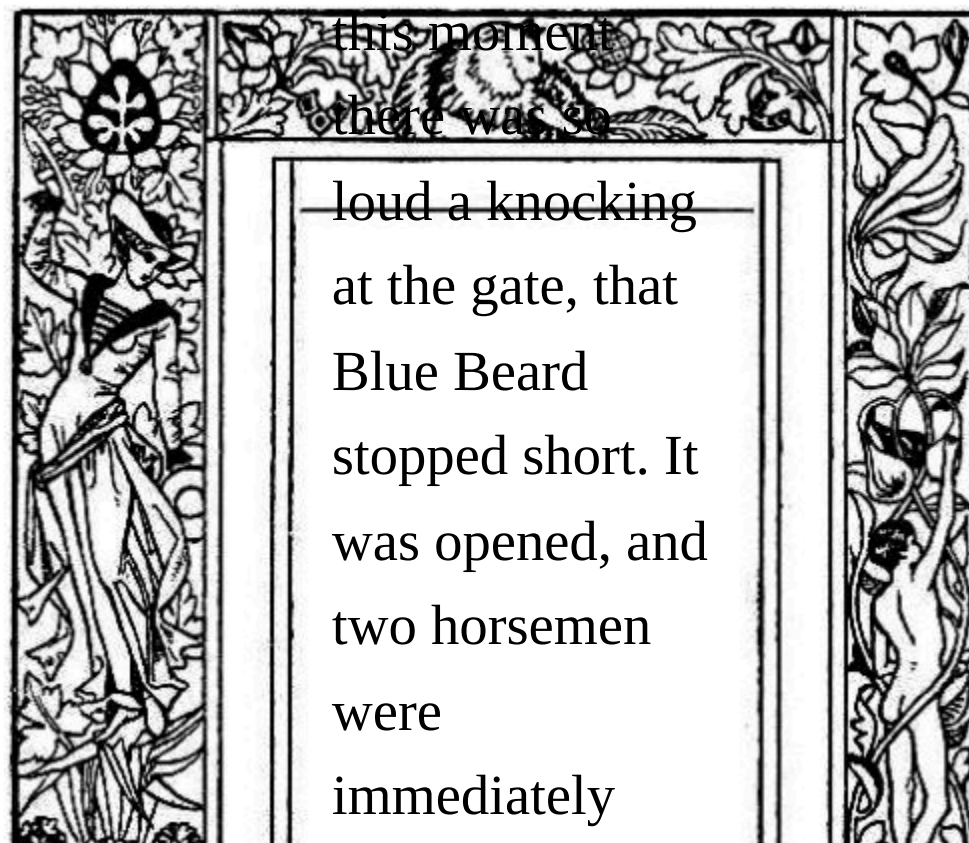
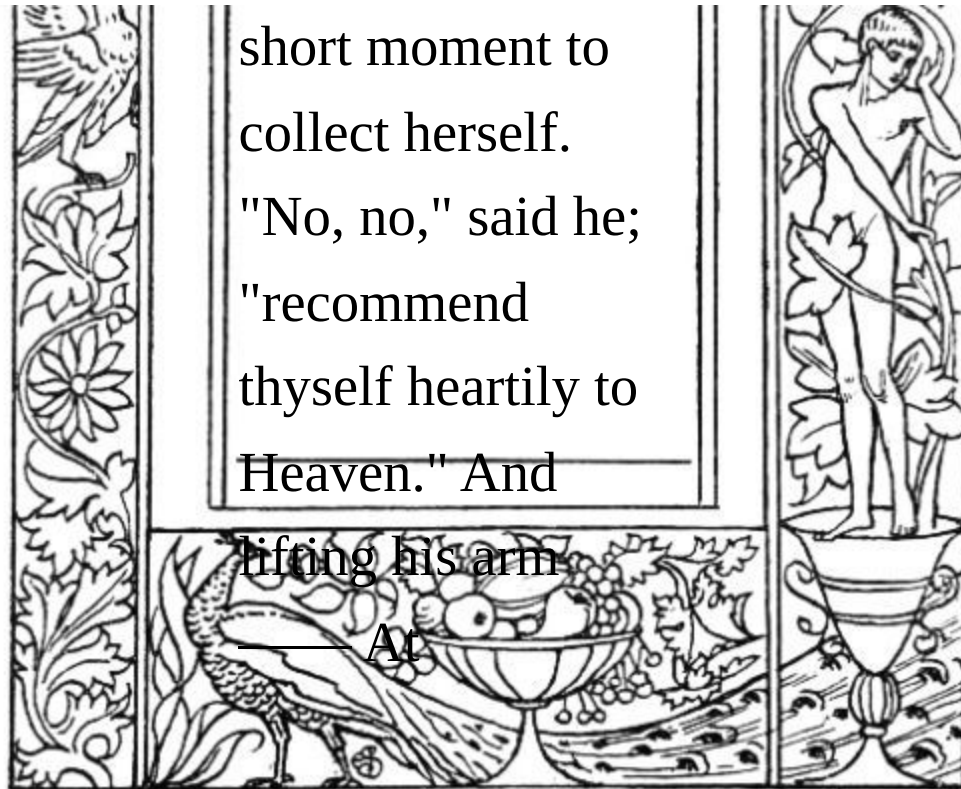
"It is of no use,"
said Blue Beard.
"You must die!"
Then seizing her
by the hair with
one hand, and
raising his
cutlass with the
other, he was

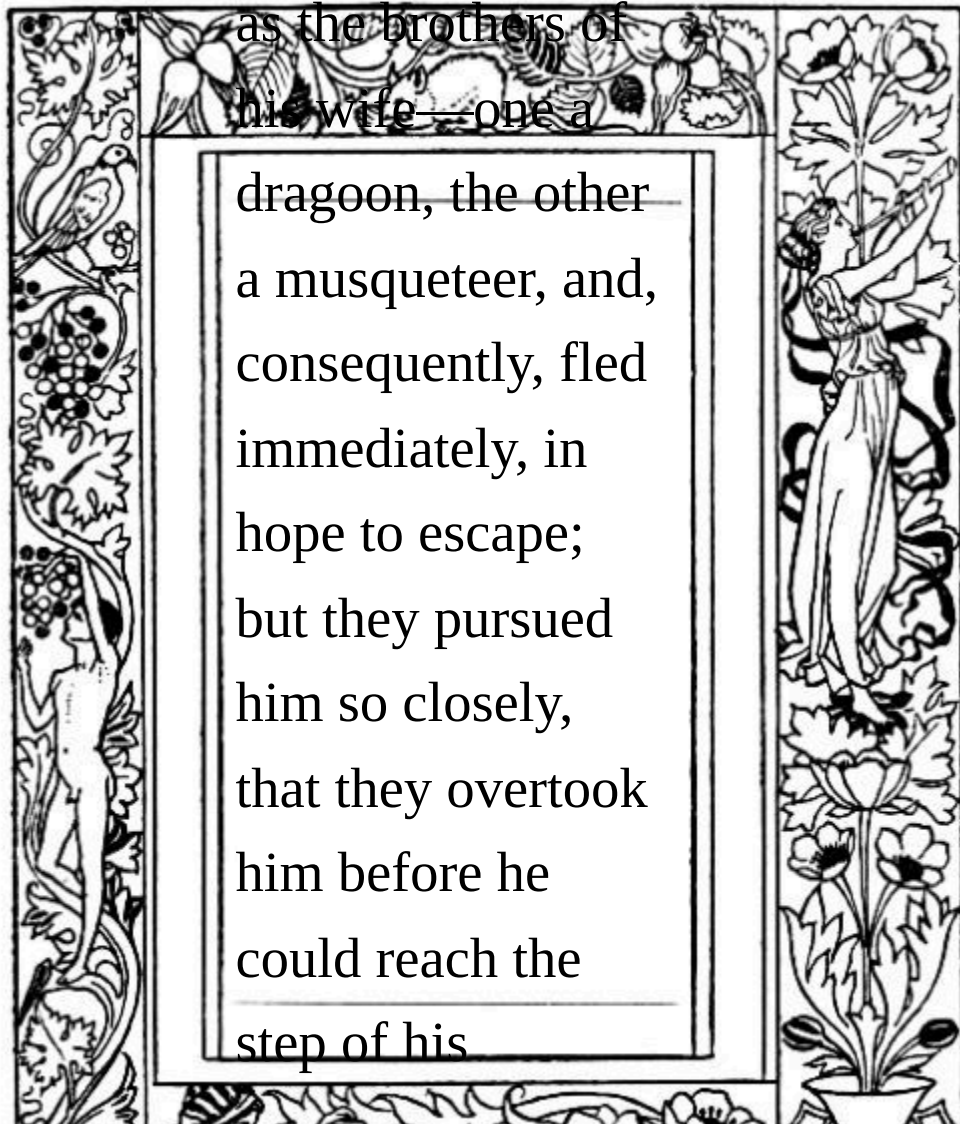
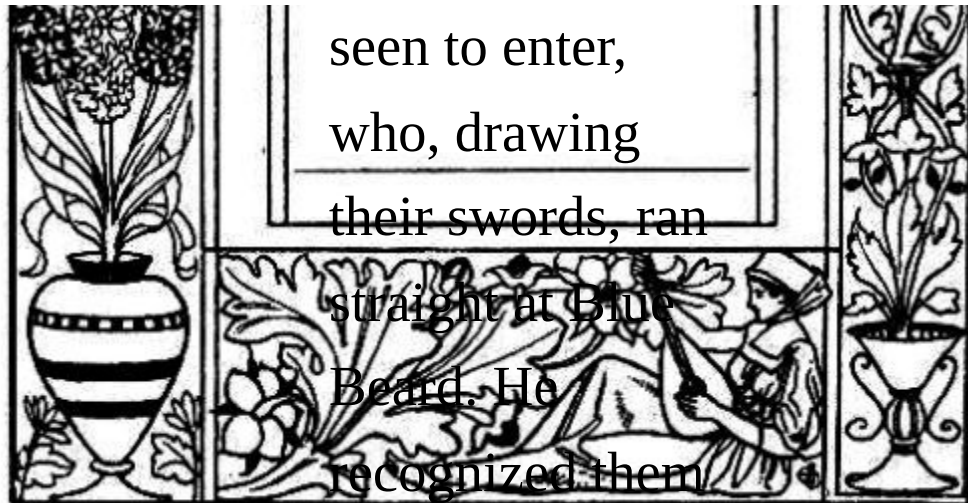
about to cut off
her head. The

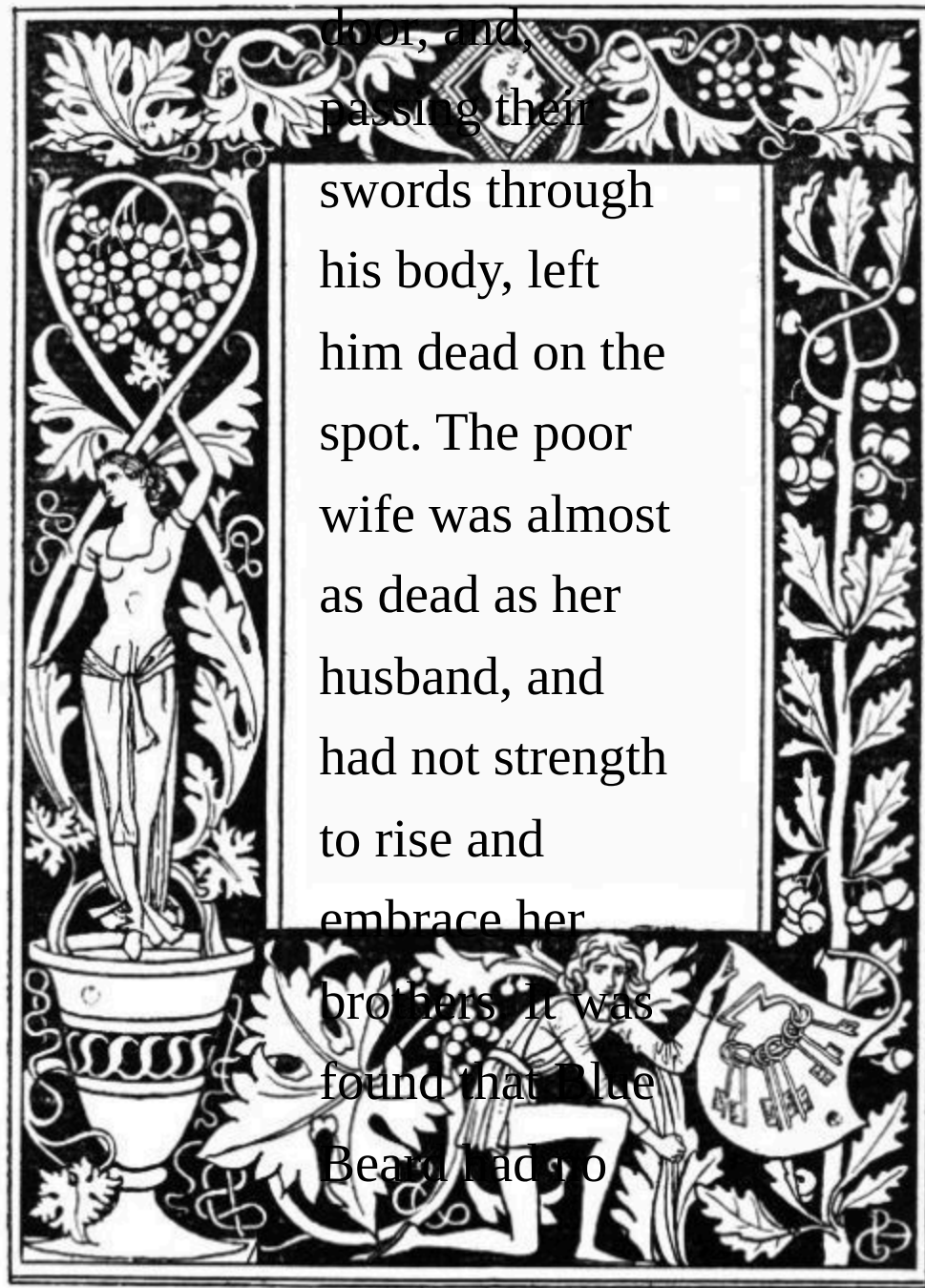


poor wife turned
towards him, and

fixing upon him
her dying eyes,
implored him to
allow her one



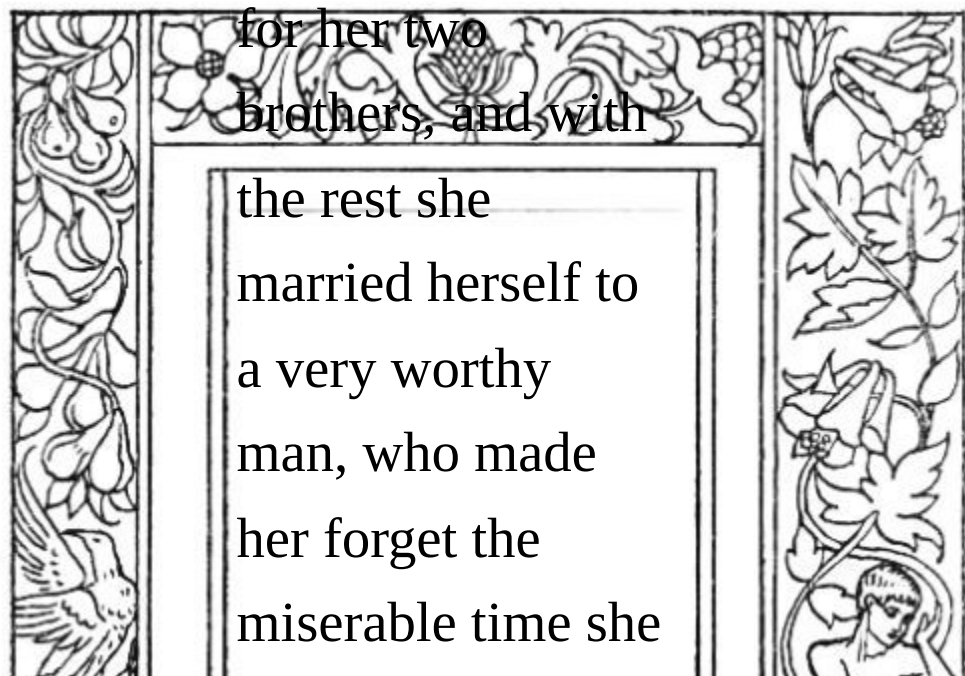
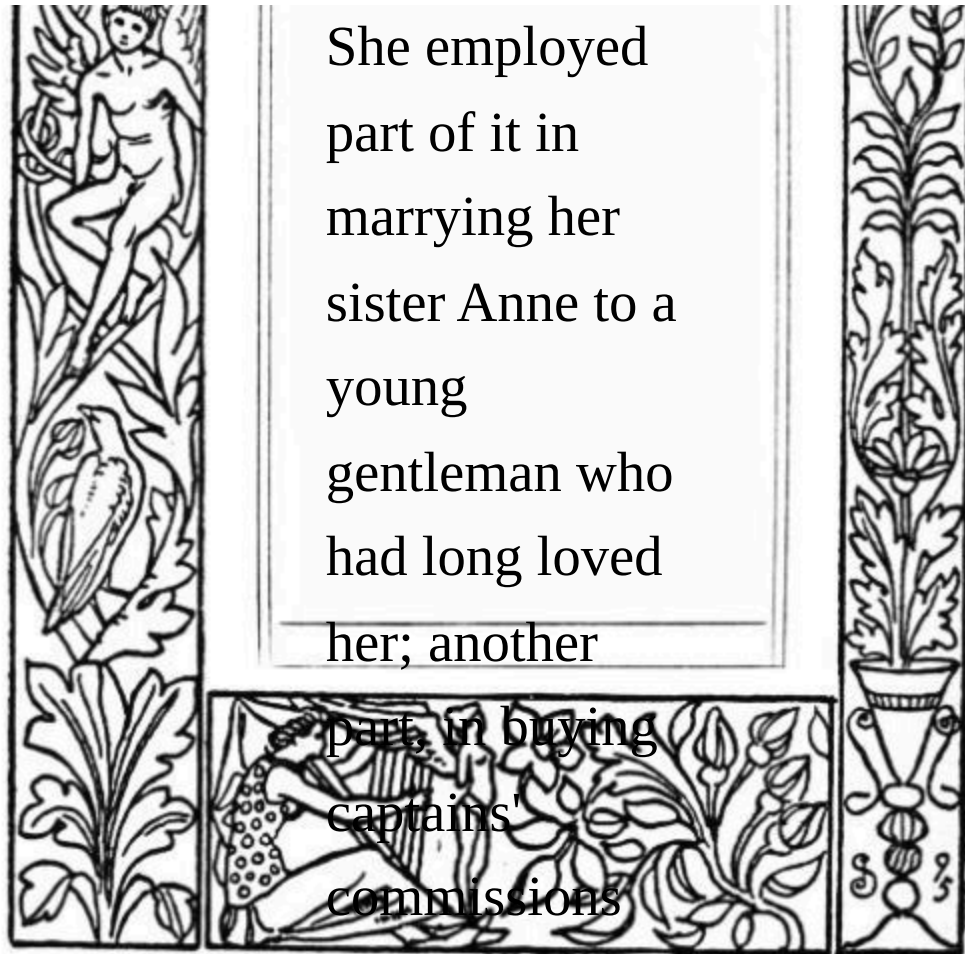


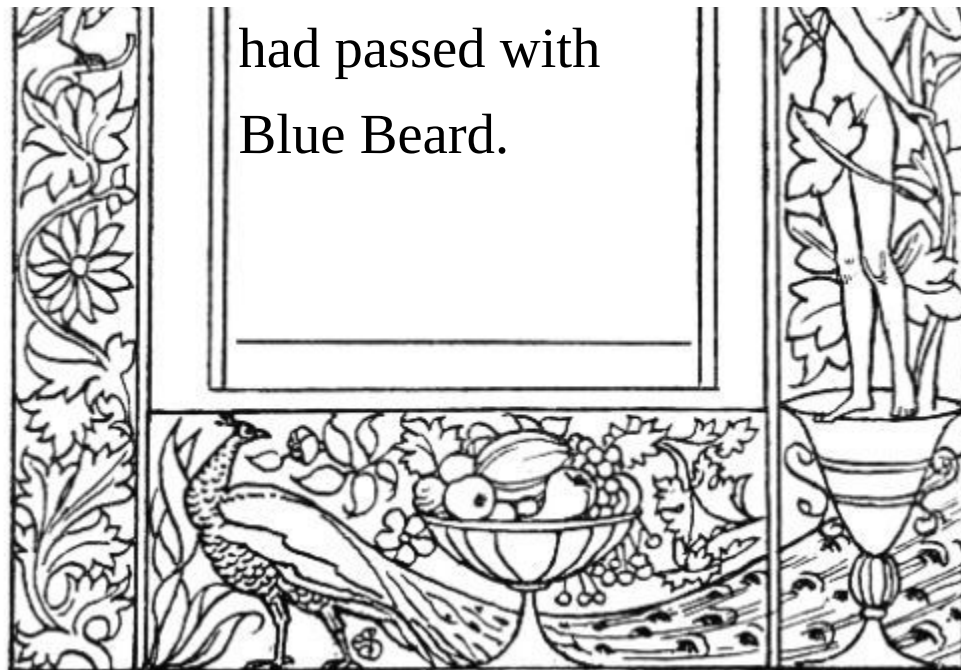




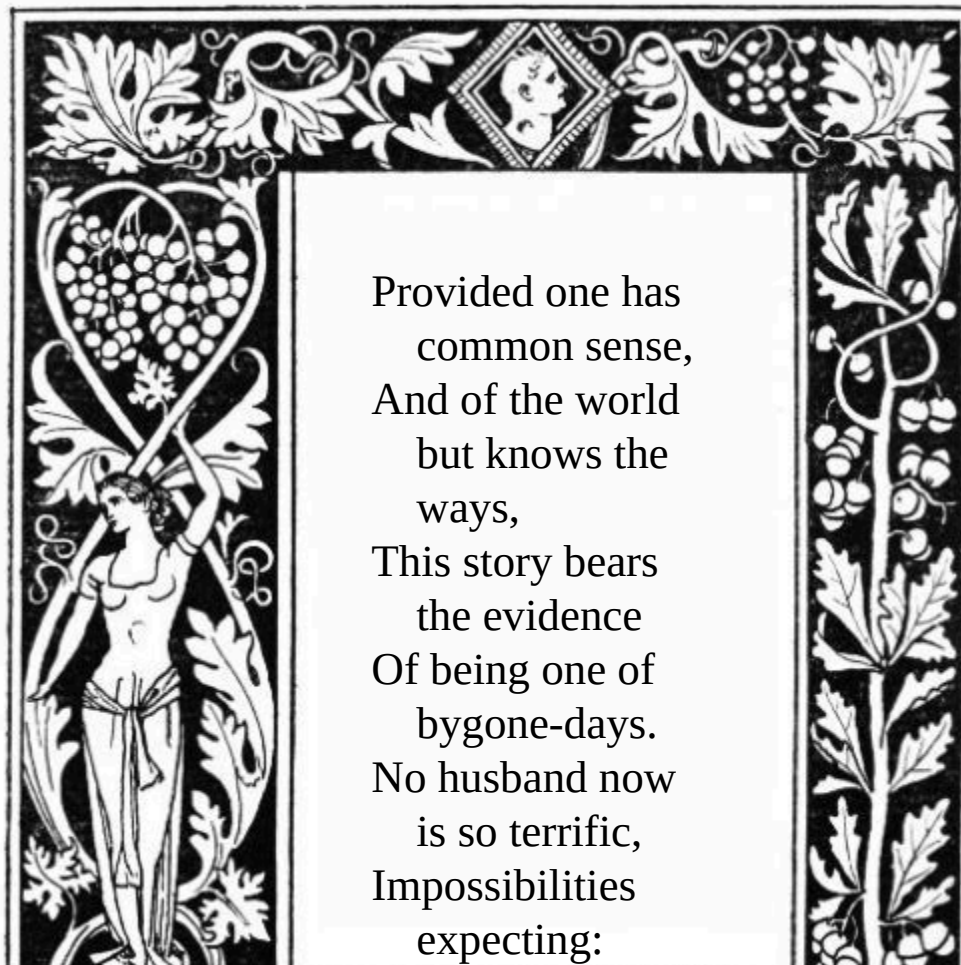
heirs, and so his
widow remained

possessed of all
his property.

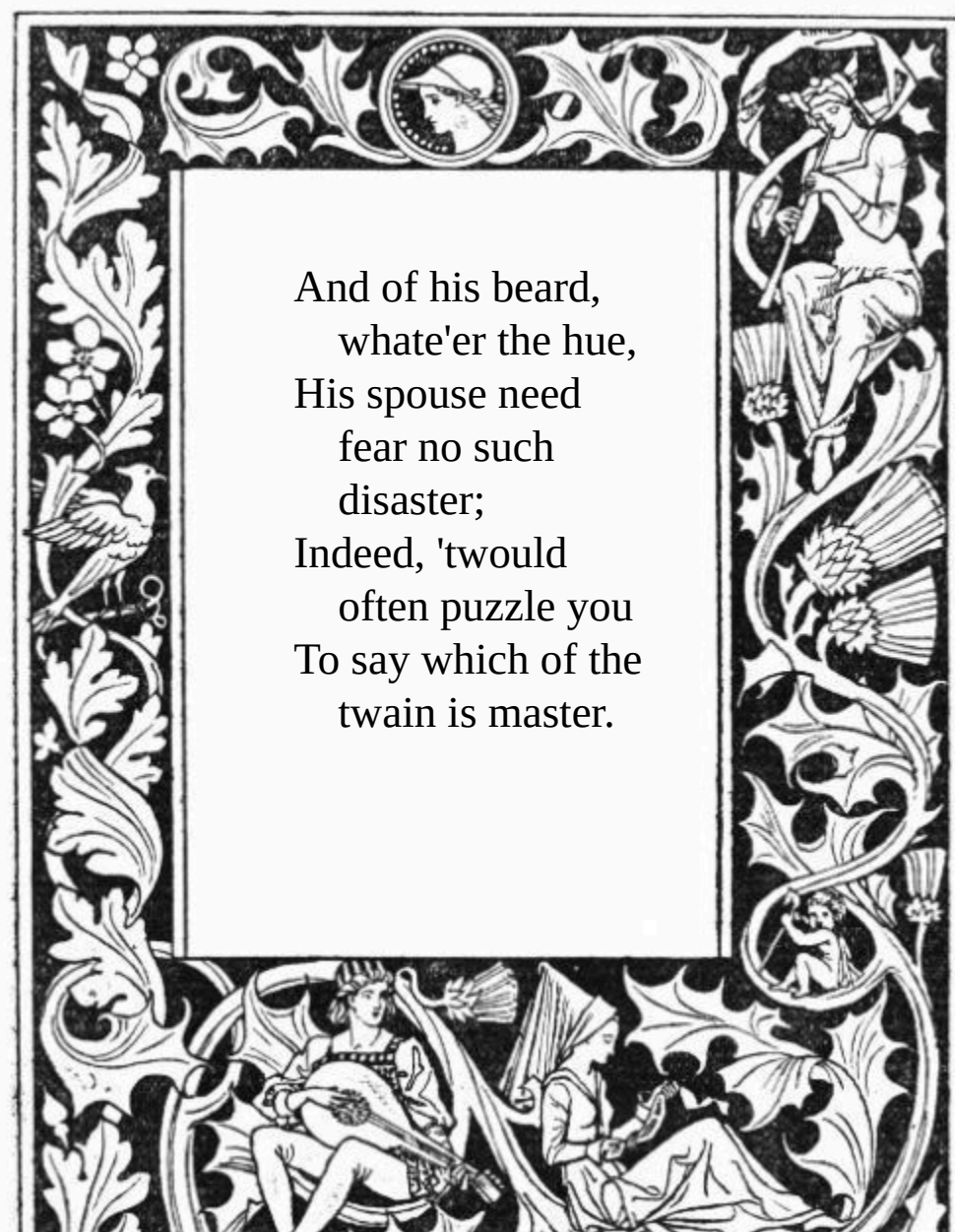




had passed with
Blue Beard.



Provided one has
common sense,
And of the world
but knows the
ways,
This story bears
the evidence
Of being one of
bygone-days.
No husband now
is so terrific,
Impossibilities
expecting:





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FOOTNOTES:

[1] Gueridons, *i. e.* stands to place lights or china upon. The word is now used to signify any small round table with one foot; but the old-fashioned stand, which was higher than a table, and its top not bigger than a dessert-plate, is occasionally to be met with.

[\[2\]](#) Looking-glasses with frames of the same material were much in vogue at that period. Of silver-framed mirrors some magnificent specimens remain to us at Knowle Park, Kent.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE STORY OF
BLUE-BEARD ***

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